AN EXOTIC CONGRUENCE FOR IRREGULAR WEIGHT PICARD MODULAR FORMS

CALLE SÖNNE

Abstract. We construct a new type of congruence from irregular weight mod p Picard modular forms (for p inert) to ones of regular weight, analogous to the one obtained by [KLS] in the Hilbert modular form setting. The congruence is obtained by using a geometric Jacquet-Langlands phenomenon as established in [Vol10], to transfer irregular weight mod p Picard modular forms from the Picard modular surface to a Shimura set. We call this an *exotic* congruence, since it relates mod p automorphic forms associated to different groups. This congruence will be used in upcoming work of the author proving mod p local-global compatibility for irregular weight Picard modular forms (in the p inert case), following the strategy of [KLS].

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1. Introduction

In this paper, we establish a new type of congruence from irregular weight Picard modular forms to Picard modular forms of regular weight. In upcoming work of the author, this will be used to prove "mod p local-global compatibility" for irregular weight mod p Picard modular forms in the p inert case, in a similar vein to the upcoming work of Kansal-Levin-Savitt [KLS] in the Hilbert setting (for p unramified). Before describing the specific setting of the paper in more detail, let us give some background on the problem in the simpler case of the modular curve. For the duration of the paper, we fix a prime $p > 2$.

1.1. **Mod p modular forms.** Let $X/\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{Z}_p$ denote the compactified modular curve (of some level prime to p). Let ω denote the Hodge bundle associated to the universal family $\mathcal{E}/X$. Then, as first introduced by Katz [Kat73], we can consider mod p modular forms of weight $k \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ as elements of $H^0(X_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega^{\otimes k})$.

A modular form of *irregular weight* is just a weight one modular form. These are harder to study than their regular weight (i.e. $k \geq 2$) counterparts. One of the main tools we have for studying weight one modular form is by using *congruences* to regular weight modular forms. Here, we say that two mod p eigenforms (of potentially different weights) are congruent if their mod p Hecke eigensystems are the same at almost all primes. In particular, the Galois representations associated to two congruent mod p modular forms will be the same.

1.2. **Mod p local-global compatibility for weight one modular forms.** The following theorem, which follows from a simplified version of [CG18, Theorem 3.11], can be seen as an instance of mod p local-global compatibility for weight one modular forms.

Theorem 1.1 ([CG18])**.** *Given a weight one modular form $f \in H^0(X_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega)$, let ρ_f denote the associated Galois representation. Then $\rho_f|_{G_{\mathbb{Q}_p}}$ is unramified.*

Let us give some remarks on why this theorem (and the corresponding generalizations for other groups) is interesting.

Remark 1.2.
(1) Theorems of this type are important for extending modularity lifting theorems beyond the regular weight case. Namely, the correct Galois deformation rings to consider will specify local conditions at p. In the case of weight one modular forms, the local condition is that the Galois representation is unramified at p. Hence, Theorem 1.1 (or rather the full statement of [CG18, Theorem 3.11]) is required for constructing the morphism "$R \to \mathbb{T}$".
(2) This question is closely related to extensions of the weight part of Serre's conjecture beyond the regular weight case. For modular forms, this was first considered (and proved) in [Edi92]. Recently, Diamond-Sasaki [DS22] formulated an analogous extension in the setting of Hilbert modular forms.
(3) The most interesting case of this theorem is when f does not admit a lift to characteristic 0. It is crucial to prove the theorem also in these cases if one wants to use the method of [CG18] to obtain modularity lifting theorems.

1.3. **The work of Kansal-Levin-Savitt.** In their upcoming work [KLS], the authors solve the analogous question in the Hilbert setting (assuming p is unramified in the totally real field). This means that the Shimura varieties they work with are Hilbert modular varieties, and the automorphic forms are Hilbert modular forms. The analogue of weight one modular forms in their setting are then the *partial weight one* Hilbert modular forms. From now on, we will refer to these as *irregular weight* Hilbert modular forms.

Their approach goes as follows. The first step is to establish multiple congruences from irregular weight Hilbert modular forms to ones of regular weight. Once they have these congruences, they then prove the conjecture by an argument purely on the Galois side. In order to have enough congruences in all cases, they establish a new type of congruence beyond the well-known congruences obtained from *partial Hasse invariants* and *theta operators*. This congruence is obtained by transferring the Hilbert modular form to a quaternionic Shimura variety of smaller dimension, using a so-called *geometric Jacquet-Langlands* phenomenon. This produces a quaternionic Hilbert modular form, with the same mod p Hecke eigensystem (away from p), and of regular weight.

Remark 1.3. Let us mention some other relevant work in the Hilbert setting. First, Wiersema [Wie25] was able to prove mod p local-global compatibility for Hilbert modular forms in the cases when this third type of congruence is not needed. There is also the work of Dimitrov-Wiese [DW20], who proved mod p local-global compatibility in the case of parallel weight one, and Diamond-Sasaki [DS22] proved mod p local-global compatibility in the ordinary case.

1.4. **Mod p Picard modular forms.** The goal of this paper is to establish an analogue of this new type of congruence for mod p Picard modular forms of irregular weight. Since this will really be a congruence between Picard modular forms on different Shimura varieties, we propose to call this an *exotic* congruence. Let us now briefly introduce the Shimura variety of interest, and the spaces of mod p Picard modular forms. We refer to the main text for more details.

1.4.1. *The Shimura variety.* Fix an imaginary quadratic field $E/\mathbb{Q}$ such that p is inert in E. Our Shimura variety $\mathrm{Sh}_K / \operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ (of some level K, but we ignore this during the introduction) will be the moduli space of principally polarized abelian threefolds, equipped with an $\mathcal{O}_E$-action and

satisfying the Kottwiz determinant condition of signature $(2,1)$. Let $\mathcal{A}/\operatorname{Sh}_K$ denote the universal abelian variety.

We will also be considering the so-called *flag Shimura varieties*. These are useful as they allow us to describe mod p Picard modular forms as sections of line bundles, whereas on the Shimura variety they can only be described as sections of vector bundles in general. Let us remark that for the modular curve, the "flag modular curve" is just the modular curve itself. We let $\mathcal{F}l_K/\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ denote the corresponding flag Shimura variety. It comes equipped with a morphism $\pi : \mathcal{F}l_K \to \operatorname{Sh}_K$, whose fibers are pointwise isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}^1$.

1.4.2. *The Shimura set.* We will also consider a 0-dimensional *Shimura set* $\operatorname{Sh}'_{K'}/\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ (of some level K', which we also ignore for now). It has the same moduli interpretation as Sh_K, except we take the signature to be $(3,0)$. Let $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$ denote the associated flag Shimura variety. There is again a map $\pi' : \mathcal{F}l'_{K'} \to \operatorname{Sh}'_{K'}$, but this time it has relative dimension 3, and the fibers are given by flag varieties.

1.4.3. *Mod p Picard modular forms.* Let k denote the residue field of E_p, and choose a labelling $\operatorname{Hom}(k,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p) = \{\tau_0,\tau_1\}$. Let $\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}$ denote the τ_0-isotypic component of the Hodge bundle of $\mathcal{A}/\operatorname{Sh}_K$. The signature condition implies that this is of rank 2. We can then define the *automorphic vector bundles* $\omega(k,l) := \operatorname{Sym}^k \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \otimes \det{}^l \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}$ on Sh_K for $k,l \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $k \geq 0$ (for simplicity we only use two parameters here, see §3.3 for a more general definition). A mod p Picard modular form of (coherent) weight $\lambda = (k,l)$ is then given by an element of $H^0(\operatorname{Sh}_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega(\lambda))$. Note that we do not need to consider compactifications here by Koecher's principle [Lan16]. We can also define a line bundle $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)$ on $\mathcal{F}l_K$ such that $H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda)) = H^0(\operatorname{Sh}_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega(\lambda))$.

In our setting, a weight (k,l) will be *irregular* if $l = 2$. The point is that these are the weights for which, in characteristic 0, the automorphic representations contributing to the cuspidal cohomology will be holomorphic limits of discrete series at ∞ (see e.g. [Gol14, §2] [Har89, §3] [BHR94]).

We can also consider Picard modular forms on the Shimura set $\operatorname{Sh}'_{K'}$. Given any tuple $\lambda = (a,b) \in \mathbb{Z}^{\oplus 2}_{\geq 0}$ one can define an automorphic vector bundle $\omega'(\lambda)$ on $\operatorname{Sh}'_{K'}$. Here we again only use 2 parameters to describe the weight for simplicity, and throughout the introduction we will be ignoring issues with determinant and multiplier twists. The global sections of $\omega'(\lambda)$ can be identified with spaces of *algebraic automorphic forms* in the sense of Gross [Gro99], see §3.8.2. We can also define automorphic line bundles $\mathcal{L}'(\lambda)$ over $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$.

1.5. **Weight-changing operators.** A great source of congruences are given by so-called *weight-changing operators*. These are Hecke-equivariant maps between spaces of automorphic forms in characteristic p. There are two well-established types of weight-changing operators that have been developed for Hodge-type Shimura varieties (which includes our setting).

First are the *partial Hasse invariants*, which were defined in [GK19b]. These are certain automorphic forms with trivial Hecke-action, so that multiplication by them provide weight-changing operators. They are naturally defined on the corresponding flag Shimura varieties.

Next are the *theta operators*. These are certain Hecke-equivariant differential operators between spaces of automorphic forms of different weights. They have been defined for Hodge-type Shimura varieties in [Ort26].

1.6. **Mod p local-global compatibility.** Just like in the modular curve case, we can associate mod p Galois representations to mod p Picard modular forms. More precisely, given a mod p Picard modular form f, we obtain a Galois representation $\rho_f : G_E \to \mathrm{GL}_3(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)$ that is essentially conjugate self-dual. We can now state *mod p local-global compatibility for irregular weight Picard modular forms.*

Conjecture 1.4. *For any $f \in H^0(\mathrm{Sh}_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega(k,2))$ with $0 \leq k \leq p-1$, the associated local Galois representation $\rho_f|_{G_{E_p}}$ admits a crystalline lift with Hodge-Tate cocharacter $\mu(\lambda) := (k+2,1,1)$ with respect to the embedding $\tau_0 : E_p \to \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$.*

Remark 1.5.
(1) This can be seen as an analogue of Theorem 1.1, as (in the notation of that theorem) $\rho_f|_{G_{\mathbb{Q}_p}}$ being unramified is equivalent to it admitting a crystalline lift of Hodge-Tate weights $\{0,0\}$.
(2) We do not expect the analogue of the conjecture to hold for $k \geq p$. The reason is that for those weights, there exists a partial Hasse invariant giving an injective weight-changing operator from some regular weight to that irregular weight. But on the EG-stack, the corresponding irregular locus will have codimension 1, whereas the corresponding regular locus will have codimension 0. In other words, we expect the space of irregular weight mod p Picard modular forms to be too big in those cases.
(3) The explicit formula we use for the Hodge-Tate cocharacter draws from the characteristic 0 setting, where it is predicted that the infinitesimal character of an automorphic representation determines the Hodge-Tate weights of the associated Galois representation [BG14, Remark 3.2.3].

1.7. **Main result.** The main result of this paper is the following, establishing an exotic congruence from irregular weight Picard modular forms on Sh_K to p-restricted regular weight Picard modular forms on $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$, where the regular weight can be pinned down to one out of two options. The following is a simplified version of Theorem 6.3 which avoids introducing additional notation at this stage (in particular, we do not account for determinant or multiplier twists).

Theorem 1.6. *Fix an irregular weight $\lambda = (k,2)$ with $0 \leq k \leq p-1$. Set $\lambda_1 = (p-1-k,k)$ and $\lambda_2 = (1,p-2-k)$. Then, if $k \leq p-2$ and $p > 3$, every mod p Hecke eigensystem appearing in $H^0(\mathrm{Sh}_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega(\lambda))$, must appear in either $H^0(\mathrm{Sh}'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(\lambda_1))$ or $H^0(\mathrm{Sh}'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(\lambda_2))$. If $k = p-1$, then the corresponding mod p Hecke eigensystem must appear in $H^0(\mathrm{Sh}'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(\lambda_1))$.*

Figure 1 illustrates the corresponding Hodge-Tate cocharacters $\mu(\lambda)$ and $\mu(\lambda_i)$, viewed inside the two p-restricted alcoves. The yellow points indicates the corresponding Hodge-Tate weights for $k = 0$, and the lines are directed, meaning that as k increases, the Hodge-Tate weight moves along the corresponding line. Note that the red line, corresponding to $\mu(\lambda_2)$, is of length $p-1$ whereas the other two are of length p. This is because in the case $a - b = p - 1$, the theorem provides a single possible regular weight $\mu(\lambda_1)$.

Let us make some remarks about this result.

Remark 1.7.
(1) The case $a - b = p - 1$ is simultaneously the most important case of this theorem, and also when it is the most powerful. This is because, in this case, one can check that the partial Hasse invariants do not produce p-restricted congruences. We therefore expect that, in order to to prove mod p local-global compatibility in this case, one would need the congruence provided by our theorem, as well as a congruence produced by a theta operator.
(2) The case $a - b = 0$ is also important, but unfortunately provides no additional information. This is because λ_2 can already be obtained from a partial Hasse invariant. In upcoming work, we show how to eliminate λ_2 under genericity conditions on the Hecke eigensystem.
(3) For the cases $1 < a - b < p - 1$, the weight $\mu(\lambda_2)$ is Fontaine-Laffaille (i.e. lies in the lowest alcove). We expect that in those cases, one could eliminate this weight by a purely Galois-theoretic argument on the EG-stack (using the partial Hasse and theta congruences available in these cases).

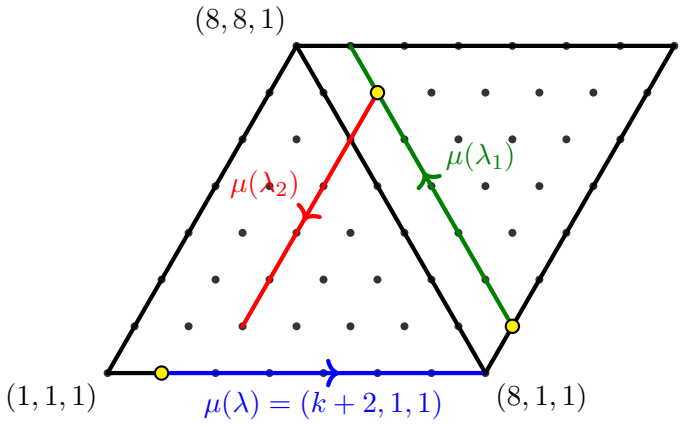


FIGURE 1. Illustration of the Hodge-Tate weights in Theorem 1.6 for $p = 7$ (up to determinant twists).

(4) Notice that, unlike the partial Hasse invariants and theta operators, the congruence we obtain is not given by a weight-shift but also involves reflections. A similar phenomenon happens in the setting of [KLS].

1.8. **Geometric Jacquet-Langlands.** The geometric Jacquet-Langlands phenomenon in our setting was first worked out by Vollaard [Vol10] (although in a slightly different language). Namely, the paper completely describes the 1-dimensional supersingular locus of Sh_K. In particular, it is reducible, and the irreducible components are all given by Fermat curves (i.e. curves in $\mathbb{P}^2$ cut out by the equation $x^{p+1} + y^{p+1} + z^{p+1} = 0$). Furthermore, the set of irreducible components is in bijection with the Shimura set $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$. This can be rephrased as the existence of a correspondence

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & \mathcal{C} & & \\ & \swarrow^{p} & & \searrow^{p'} & \\ \mathrm{Sh}_K & & & & \mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}, \end{array}$$

where $\mathcal{C}$ is given by a disjoint union of Fermat curves, one for each point in $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$. The map to Sh_K is then given by mapping each Fermat curve to the corresponding irreducible component of the supersingular locus. Let us note here that the notation $\mathcal{C}$ will only be used in the introduction (later there will be more precise notation relating it to a certain stratification).

This correspondence can be interpreted in a more sophisticated way on the level of flag Shimura varieties. There, we can consider the *coarse stratification*, which generalizes the a-number stratification on the Shimura variety. We can then view the above correspondence as the identification of $\mathcal{C}$ with certain strata in the respective flag Shimura varieties $\mathcal{F}l_K$ and $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. This gives us the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} & \overset{p}{\swarrow} & & \overset{i}{\swarrow} & \mathcal{C} & \overset{i'}{\searrow} & & \overset{p'}{\searrow} & \\ \mathrm{Sh}_K & \xleftarrow{\pi} & \mathcal{F}l_K & & & & \mathcal{F}l'_{K'} & \xrightarrow{\pi'} & \mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}, \end{array}$$

where i and i' are closed immersions.

1.9. **The exotic congruence.** The exotic congruence will be obtained as follows. First, given an irregular weight λ, we compute $i^*\mathcal{L}(\lambda)$ in terms of line bundles on the flag Shimura variety $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. More precisely, we find a weight λ' such that $i^*\mathcal{L}(\lambda) \cong i'^*\mathcal{L}'(\lambda')$. Next, we must compute $p'_* i'^* \mathcal{L}'(\lambda')$ in terms of automorphic vector bundles on $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$, whose weights we can describe explicitly. Pulling

back a Picard modular form from $\mathcal{F}l_K$ to $\mathcal{C}$ and then pushing forward to $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$ will then give us the desired exotic congruence.

Let us end the introduction with the following remark, regarding the possibility of eliminating the weight λ_2 without appealing to Galois theory. An initial hope of ours was that, by working on the supersingular locus in Sh_K instead of on $\mathcal{C}$ (which can be identified with its normalization), one should be able to eliminate λ_2 by analyzing the local intersections between the Fermat curves. However, it seems that the obstruction rather comes from the "global structure" of the supersingular locus, i.e. how the tree of Fermat curves from [Vol10] folds in on itself. More precisely, one can show that λ_2 can not be eliminated on the level of reduced Rapoport-Zink spaces. In other words, on the reduced Rapoport-Zink space there will exist sections which obtain weight λ_2 through an analogue of the exotic congruence on the level of reduced Rapoport-Zink spaces. However, we do not expect such sections to descend to the supersingular locus of the Shimura variety. Since we do not know how to get explicit control of this quotient, using it to eliminate λ_2 seems very difficult.

1.10. **Contents of the paper.** In §2, we start by recalling some Dieudonné theory from [BBM82]. In particular, we are interested in how the Hodge filtration changes upon a quotient by an F,V-kernel. This is described in Lemma 2.9, and will later be useful when computing the automorphic line bundles on $\mathcal{F}l_K$ restricted to $\mathcal{C}$. Next, in §3, we introduce the Shimura varieties Sh_K and $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$, their associated flag varieties and the automorphic vector bundles. We also compute explicitly some partial Hasse invariants in both cases, and write down explicit conditions defining certain strata in their respective coarse stratifications. In §4 we establish a version of the geometric Jacquet-Langlands phenomenon first discovered in [Vol10]. The main difference to Vollaard's work is that, since we are interested in describing the automorphic line bundles, we must also describe the universal abelian variety together with its Hodge filtration on this stratum. The main new result of the section is Theorem 4.12, which gives a description of the automorphic line bundle $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)$ in terms of automorphic line bundles on a partial flag Shimura variety. In §5, our goal is to compute the pushforward of $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\mathcal{C}}$ to $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$ in terms of automorphic vector bundles with explicit weights. This is Theorem 5.1. We show how, using the stack of G-zips, this reduces to the calculation of the cohomology of a certain line bundle on a Fermat curve, as a $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representation. This calculation is then the content of Theorem 5.10. Finally, in §6 we apply Theorem 5.1 to obtain our main result, Theorem 6.3. This requires us to show that restriction to the stratum $\mathcal{C}$ is injective on global sections, which we do by an argument using partial Hasse invariants.

1.11. **Acknowledgements.** I want thank my advisor George Boxer for suggesting this problem, and for the numerous discussions we have had whilst I was working on this topic. I also want to thank my other advisor, Fred Diamond, for comments and helpful discussions. Finally I want to also thank Martin Ortiz and Yicheng Yang for conversations about this work.

1.12. **Statement of AI use.** Gemini was used to produce Figure 1, and it was also helpful when producing the notation section. Other than this, no AI has been used in the creation of this article.

1.13. **Notation.**

1.13.1. *Frobenius.* Given a scheme $S/\mathbb{F}_p$, let σ_S (or simply σ) denote the absolute p-power Frobenius endomorphism on S. Given a scheme X/S, we set $X^{(p)} := X \times_{S,\sigma} S$. For a sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ over S, we will use the notation $\mathcal{F}^{(p^r)} := \sigma_S^{[r],*}\mathcal{F}$ to denote the r-fold pullback along σ_S.

1.13.2. *Witt vectors.* Given a perfect field $k/\mathbb{F}_p$, we let $W(k)$ denote the ring of Witt vectors of k. By an abuse of notation, we will also write σ for the canonical lift of the Frobenius automorphism σ_k to $W(k)$. Furthermore, we will use the notation $\mathbb{Z}_{p^2} := W(\mathbb{F}_{p^2})$ and $\mathbb{Q}_{p^2} := \mathbb{Z}_{p^2}[\frac{1}{p}]$.

1.13.3. *Characters and cocharacters.* Given an algebraic group G over a field k, we let $X^*(G)$ (resp. $X_*(G)$) denote the group of characters (resp. cocharacters) of $G_{\overline{k}}$.

1.13.4. *Root datum.* Let G be a connected reductive group equipped with a maximal torus $T \subseteq G$. Then we will let R denote the associated set of T-roots in $X^*(T)$. We denote the set of simple roots by Δ. Given a choice of a Borel subgroup containing T, we denote the corresponding set of positive roots by R^+ (and the positive simple roots by Δ^+). We say a character $\lambda \in X^*(T)$ is p-restricted if $0 \leq \langle \lambda, \alpha^\vee \rangle \leq p-1$ for all $\alpha \in \Delta^+$.

1.13.5. *Duals.* We will employ various notations for duals. For a vector space V, V^* will denote its dual vector space. For an abelian variety or a p-divisible group A, we let $A^\vee$ denote its dual. Finally, for a finite flat commutative group scheme G over a base S, G^D will denote its Cartier dual.

1.13.6. *Miscellaneous.* Given a morphism of schemes $X \xrightarrow{\pi} S$, we let $\mathcal{H}^i_{dR}(X/S)$ (or just $\mathcal{H}^i_{dR}(X)$) denote the de Rham cohomology sheaves over S. If X is a group scheme, we let $\omega_{X/S}$ (often just ω_X) denote the co-Lie algebra. Similarly, we denote the Lie algebra by $\mathrm{Lie}(X/S)$ (often just $\mathrm{Lie}(X)$).

2. Dieudonné theory

In this section we will recall some results of [BBM82], adapted for our purposes, and derive some basic consequences. Throughout this section, we will fix a finite field $k/\mathbb{F}_p$ and a scheme S over $\operatorname{Spec} k$.

2.1. **Some remarks on the Crystalline site.** Most of the results in [BBM82] are stated in terms of sheaves on the crystalline site. We will not be using this site directly, but we are interested in the consequences of these results for Dieudonné modules, and a family version of what is called "Dieudonné spaces" in [VW11]. Therefore our first goal will be to explain how sheaves on the crystalline site relate to these objects, as well as fixing some notation.

In [BBM82] they associate to any abelian sheaf G on S, a sheaf that we denote by $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$ on the crystalline site of S over $W(k)$. This construction is contravariantly functorial in G. Let us remark that whilst in [BBM82], they use the notation $\mathbb{D}(G)$ for this sheaf, we choose to use $\mathcal{D}_{cris}$ instead. The reason being that it is common in the literature to use the notation $\mathcal{D}(-)$ for the contravariant Dieudonné functor, and $\mathbb{D}(-)$ for the covariant one. There is a morphism of topoi $Sh((S/W(k))_{cris}) \to Sh(S_{zar})$ (Here S_{zar} denotes the small Zariski site on S), allowing us to pull back sheaves on the cristalline site to the Zariski site on S. We can now produce the following two objects of interest from $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$.

(1) Pulling back $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$ to S_{zar} gives us an $\mathcal{O}_S$-module $\mathcal{D}(G)_S$. We will call this the *Dieudonné space* associated to G.
(2) When $S = \operatorname{Spec} k$, we let $\mathcal{D}(G)$ denote the $W(k)$-module obtained by taking global sections of $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$ over the crystalline site. This is the Dieudonné module associated to G.

The sheaf $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$ always comes equipped with a Frobenius morphism

$$F : \mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)^{(p)} \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}_{cris}(G),$$

This in turn induces Frobenius morphisms on $\mathcal{D}(G)_S$ resp. $\mathcal{D}(G)$ (for $S = \operatorname{Spec} k$). Similarly, whenever G possesses a Verschiebung morphism, we obtain one on $\mathcal{D}_{cris}(G)$. It will be denoted by V, and it will satisfy the standard compatability with F. If any confusion can occur, we will add a subscript to denote the associated group (i.e. F_G resp. V_G).

2.2. **Dieudonné spaces.** Let's now collect some relevant results from [BBM82] concerning Dieudonné spaces associated to abelian schemes, p-divisible groups and finite flat group schemes.

The following proposition sums up the main properties that we will use about the associated Dieudonné space.

Proposition 2.1. *Let X/S be a p-divisible group. Then we have*

(i) $\mathcal{D}(X)_S$ is locally free of rank equal to the height of X.
(ii) $\mathcal{D}(X)_S \cong \mathcal{D}(X)_S/p\mathcal{D}(X)_S \cong \mathcal{D}(X[p])_S$, where $X[p]$ denotes the p-torsion subgroup.

(iii) We have a canonical Hodge filtration

$$0 \longrightarrow \omega_X \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(X)_S \longrightarrow \mathrm{Lie}(X^\vee) \longrightarrow 0.$$

(iv) If there exists an abelian scheme A/S such that $X \cong A[p^\infty]$, then we have

$$\mathcal{D}(X)_S \cong \mathcal{D}(A)_S \cong \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A/S).$$

Moreover, this isomorphism is compatible with Hodge filtrations.

(v) If $S = \operatorname{Spec} k$, we have $\mathcal{D}(X)_{\operatorname{Spec} k} \cong \mathcal{D}(X)/p\mathcal{D}(X)$.

Proof. The first three parts follow from Théorème 3.3.10, Proposition 3.3.13 and Corollarie 3.3.5 of [BBM82] respectively. Next, iv) follows from Propositions 3.3.7 and 2.5.8. The final result follows from the fact that $\mathcal{D}(X)$ is a crystal. □

From now on, due to part (iv) of the above proposition, we will generally replace $\mathcal{D}(A)_S$ with $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)$ for abelian schemes A over S.

Remark 2.2. Part (v) of the proposition shows that for $S = \operatorname{Spec} k$, the notion of "Dieudonné space" we use here coincides with the one in [VW11, (1.3)].

The following lemma will allow us to describe $\mathcal{D}(G)_S$ for G a finite flat group scheme annihilated by F_G.

Proposition 2.3. *Given a finite flat group scheme G over S (or a p-divisible group), we have a canonical isomorphism*

$$\mathcal{D}(G)_S/F(\mathcal{D}(G)_S^{(p)}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \omega_G^{(p)}.$$

Moreover, this isomorphism fits into the following commutative diagram, where the arrow on the right is obtained from the (p)-twisted Hodge filtration.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{D}(G)_S/F(\mathcal{D}(G)_S^{(p)}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \omega_G^{(p)} \\ & \searrow^{V} & \downarrow \\ & & \mathcal{D}(G)_S^{(p)} \end{array}$$

Proof. This follows from [BBM82, Proposition 4.3.10], after pullback to S_{zar}. □

2.3. **Dieudonné complexes.** Given a finite flat group scheme G over S, let $\Delta(G)_S \in D(\mathcal{O}_S)$ denote the (contravariant) *Dieudonné complex*, which we define to be the pullback to the Zariski site of the complex defined in [BBM82, Définition 3.1.5]. Since inverse image functors between topoi are exact, it follows (from the definition) that $\mathcal{H}^1(\Delta(G)_S) = \mathcal{D}(G)_S$. The reason we are interested in this complex is that, as we shall soon see, certain theorems about Dieudonné modules of p-divisible groups have analogue statements for Dieudonné complexes of finite flat group schemes. The following theorem shows us that $\Delta(G)_S$ is not so complicated.

Theorem 2.4. *For a finite flat group scheme G, $\Delta(G)_S$ is representable by a perfect complex of $\mathcal{O}_S$-modules, with perfect amplitude contained in $[0, 1]$.*

Proof. This is [BBM82, Theorem 3.1.2 (i)]. □

For a finite flat group scheme S, we will let $\ell_{G/S} \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{O}_S)$ denote its co-Lie complex. Since finite flat group schemes are locally complete intersections, $\ell_{G/S}$ has cohomological amplitude contained in the range $[-1, 0]$. Recall that $\omega_G \cong \mathcal{H}^0(\ell_{G/S})$ and, following [BBM82], we will use the notation $n_G := \mathcal{H}^{-1}(\ell_{G/S})$ and $\nu_G := \mathcal{H}^1(\ell^*_{G/S})$.

The Dieudonné complex admits a well-behaved "Hodge filtration" [BBM82, Theorem 3.2.10]. We recall the statement in our notation here.

Theorem 2.5. *Fix a finite flat group scheme G over S, and let G^D/S denote its Cartier dual. There exists the following exact triangle in $D(\mathcal{O}_S)$ (functorial in G)*

$$\ell_{G/S}[-1] \longrightarrow \Delta(G)_S \longrightarrow \ell^*_{G^D/S} \xrightarrow{+1}.$$

In particular, we have the following long exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow n_G \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Lie}(G^D) \longrightarrow \omega_G \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(G)_S \longrightarrow \nu_{G^D} \longrightarrow 0.$$

The Dieudonné complex and it's Hodge filtration behaves well with respect to isogenies.

Lemma 2.6. *Given an isogeny of p-divisible groups $f : X_0 \to X_1$ over S, let G denote the kernel. Then we have the following isomorphism of perfect complexes*

$$\Delta(G)_S \cong [\mathcal{D}(X_1)_S \xrightarrow{-\mathcal{D}(f)} \mathcal{D}(X_0)_S].$$

This isomorphism is also compatible with Hodge filtrations, and in particular we get the following commutative diagram, where all rows and columns are exact

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccccc}
 & & 0 & & 0 & & 0 & & & & \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & n_G & \longrightarrow & \omega_{X_1} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{X_0} & \longrightarrow & \omega_G & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(X_1)_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(X_0)_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(G)_S & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(G^D) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(X_1^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(X_0^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \nu_{G^D} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
 & & & & 0 & & 0 & & 0 & &
\end{array}$$

Proof. This follows from [BBM82, Proposition 3.3.13]. □

2.4. **Quotients by F, V-kernels.** We say that a finite flat group scheme G/S is an F, V-kernel, if it is annihilated by both F_G and V_G. In this section we aim to understand how the Dieudonné spaces of p-divisible groups (and their Hodge filtrations) change upon quotienting by an F, V-kernel.

Lemma 2.7. *Given an F, V-kernel G over S, the long exact sequence of Theorem 2.5 becomes*

$$0 \longrightarrow n_G \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) \xrightarrow{0} \mathrm{Lie}(G^D) \xrightarrow{\sim} \omega_G \xrightarrow{0} \mathcal{D}(G)_S \xrightarrow{\sim} \nu_{G^D} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. This follows from [BBM82, Lemme 4.3.2], which implies that all terms of the long exact sequence are locally free of the same rank. □

Next, the following notation will be convenient for us. Consider a morphism $F : \mathcal{E} \to \mathcal{F}$ of abelian sheaves over some scheme S. Then, given a subquotient $\mathcal{Q}$ of $\mathcal{E}$, we will let $F(\mathcal{Q})$ denote the corresponding subquotient of $\mathcal{F}$ (which might be 0). More precisely, given an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{E}'' \longrightarrow \mathcal{E}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{Q} \longrightarrow 0,$$

with $\mathcal{E}' \subseteq \mathcal{E}$, we will let $F(\mathcal{Q})$ denote $F(\mathcal{E}')/F(\mathcal{E}'')$. We immediately use this notation in the statement of the following lemma, which will allow us to describe the action of Frobenius and Verschiebung on the quotient of a p-divisible group by an F, V-kernel.

The following lemma is clear pointwise on Dieudonné modules, but to avoid introducing unnecessary notation, we give a proof purely on the level of Dieudonné spaces.

Lemma 2.8. *Let S be a scheme of characteristic p, and let $\mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{Y}$ be an isogeny of p-divisible groups over S, with kernel G. Consider the exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{Y})_S \xrightarrow{\Phi} \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(G)_S \longrightarrow 0.$$

If G is an F,V-kernel, then both $V_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)_S)$ and $F_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)_S^{(p)})$ are non-zero, lying in the image of Φ, and we have that

$$F_{\mathcal{Y}}(V_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G))) = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$$

and

$$V_{\mathcal{Y}}(F_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)^{(p)})) = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)^{(p)}.$$

In particular, $\mathcal{D}(G)_S \cong \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$.

Proof. We only prove the first case, the second is identical. First of all, the fact that F_G is trivial implies that $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S \to \mathcal{D}(G)_S$ factors through $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S/\operatorname{Im} F_{\mathcal{X}} \to \mathcal{D}(G)_S$. Next, we use that $\operatorname{Im} F_{\mathcal{X}} = \ker V_{\mathcal{X}}$ in $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S$ (since $\mathcal{X}[p]$ is a BT_1) to deduce that $\mathcal{D}(G)_S \xrightarrow{V_{\mathcal{X}}} V_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)_S)$ is an isomorphism. Hence $\mathcal{E} := V_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)_S)$ is a vector bundle of rank equal to that of $\mathcal{D}(G)_S$, and in particular also to that of $\mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$. Since V_G is trivial, we know that $\mathcal{E}$ must lie in the image of Φ. Hence we can view $\mathcal{E}$ as a subquotient of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{Y})_S$ to make sense of the expression $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\mathcal{E})$. It remains to see that this is equal to $\mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$. First, let us show that $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\mathcal{E})$ has the same rank as $\mathcal{E}$. To do this, we need to see that $\mathcal{E}$ does not lie in the image of $V_{\mathcal{Y}}$. But this is impossible, since $V_{\mathcal{X}}^{-1}(\mathcal{E}) = \mathcal{D}(G)_S$ does not lie in the image of Φ! Thus, $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\mathcal{E})$ has rank equal to that of $\mathcal{E}$, but since $F_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{E}) = 0$, we furthermore have that $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\mathcal{E}) \subseteq \ker \Phi = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$. Since this is a containment of subbundles of the same rank, it must be an equality. □

Now we can completely describe how the Hodge filtration changes upon taking the quotient by an F,V-kernel. This lemma will be repeatedly used in §4.

Lemma 2.9. *Let S be a scheme of characteristic p, and let $\mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{Y}$ be an isogeny of p-divisible groups over S, with kernel G. If G is an F,V-kernel, then the associated short exact sequence of Hodge filtrations from Lemma 2.6 can be described as*

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & \omega_G^{(p)} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{Y}} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{X}} & \longrightarrow & \omega_G \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{Y})_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(G)_S \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \omega_G & \longrightarrow & \operatorname{Lie}(\mathcal{Y}^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \operatorname{Lie}(\mathcal{X}^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \omega_G^{(p)} \longrightarrow 0.
\end{array}$$

The isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(G)_S \cong \omega_G^{(p)}$ is induced from $V_{\mathcal{X}} : \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S \twoheadrightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{X}}^{(p)}$. Furthermore, we have that $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\omega_G^{(p)}) = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$, where ω_G can be viewed as a subobject of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{Y})_S$ since the top right vertical morphism in the diagram is 0.

Proof. Applying Lemma 2.6 and Lemma 2.7 gives us the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & n_G & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{Y}} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{X}} & \longrightarrow & \omega_G \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{Y})_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(G)_S \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \omega_G & \longrightarrow & \operatorname{Lie}(\mathcal{Y}^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \operatorname{Lie}(\mathcal{X}^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \nu_{G^D} \longrightarrow 0.
\end{array}$$

It remains to identify $\mathcal{D}(G)_S$ and $\mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$ (then we also identify n_G and ν_{G^D} for free). By Proposition 2.3 , since G is killed by F_G, we have that $\mathcal{D}(G)_S \cong \omega_G^{(p)}$. Moreover, the second part of the proposition applied to the group scheme $\mathcal{X}[p]$ implies that $V_{\mathcal{X}}(\mathcal{D}(G)_S) = \omega_G^{(p)}$, viewed as a subbundle of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{X})_S^{(p)}$. Now Lemma 2.8 gives us $F_{\mathcal{Y}}(\omega_G^{(p)}) = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S)$. In particular we get that $n_G \cong \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G)_S) \cong \omega_G^{(p)}$. This finishes the proof of the theorem. □

3. Unitary Shimura varieties

3.1. **Unitary groups.** Before defining the unitary Shimura varieties of interest, let us start with some group theoretic preliminaries.

Fix an imaginary quadratic extension E of $\mathbb{Q}$, such that p is inert in E. We will use $x \mapsto \overline{x}$ to denote the nontrivial automorphism of $E/\mathbb{Q}$. Let $\mathcal{O}_E$ denote its ring of integers. Then for any $\mathcal{O}_E$-algebra R we will let $\tau_0 : \mathcal{O}_E \to R$ denote the structure morphism, and we will let $\tau_1 := \overline{\tau_0}$ denote its conjugate. When R is an E-algebra, we will again use τ_i to denote the corresponding embedding into R.

Let V be a 3-dimensional E-vector space, equipped with a non-degenerate E-valued skew-Hermitian pairing $\{\cdot,\cdot\} : V \times V \to E$. By taking traces, we obtain a non-degenerate $\mathbb{Q}$-valued alternating pairing $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle : V \times V \to \mathbb{Q}$ given by $\langle v, w\rangle := \mathrm{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{Q}}(\{v, w\})$. Furthermore, this pairing satsifies $\langle xv, w\rangle = \langle v, \overline{x}w\rangle$ for all $x \in E$ and $v, w \in V$. Using this, we can define an algebraic group G over $\mathbb{Q}$, which for a $\mathbb{Q}$-algebra R, has its group of R-points given by

$$G(R) = \{(g, c) \in (\mathrm{Res}_{E/\mathbb{Q}} GL(V) \times \mathbb{G}_m)(R) \mid \langle gv, gw\rangle = c\langle v, w\rangle\}.$$

Let us once and for all fix a basis $V \cong E^{\oplus 3}$. The skew-Hermitian space $V_{\mathbb{R}} \cong \mathbb{C}^3$ will have some signature (r, s), where $r + s = 3$, so in particular $G_{\mathbb{R}} \cong \mathrm{GU}(r, s)$.

If we view E as an E-algebra via the identity (so that $\tau_0 = \mathrm{id}_E$), we get that $V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} E \cong V_{\tau_0} \oplus V_{\tau_1}$, where E acts on the right-hand side by τ_i on V_{τ_i}. Throughout this paper we will interpret the indices of the τ_i as lying in $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$. Let $\lambda_V : V \to V^*$ denote the morphism associated to the pairing $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle$. Note that $\lambda_V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} E$ exchanges isotypic components, and hence we can consider its restriction to V_{τ_0}

$$\lambda_{V,\tau_0} : V_{\tau_0} \longrightarrow V_{\tau_1}^*.$$

This recovers the skew-Hermitian pairing $\{\cdot,\cdot\}$. Finally, we have an identification $G_E \cong \mathrm{GL}(V_{\tau_0}) \times \mathbb{G}_{m,E}$, since the action on V_{τ_1} can be determined from the action on V_{τ_0} via λ_{V,τ_0}.

3.1.1. *Pairings in the type* $(2, 1)$ *and* $(3, 0)$ *cases.* We will mainly be interested in the two cases $(r, s) \in \{(2, 1), (3, 0)\}$. Although we will not specialize to these cases until §3.7, let us for future use fix the pairing $\{\cdot,\cdot\}$ in each case. Fix an element $\zeta \in \mathcal{O}_E$ satisfying $\overline{\zeta} = -\zeta$. In the $(2, 1)$-case, we will use the skew-Hermitian pairing given by

$$\{v, w\} := \overline{v}^t \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & \zeta \\ 0 & \zeta & 0 \\ \zeta & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} w.$$

We make this choice so that the upper-triangular Borel descends from G_E to G. In the $(3, 0)$-case, we will use the standard skew-Hermitian pairing

$$\{v, w\}' := \overline{v}^t \begin{pmatrix} \zeta & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \zeta & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \zeta \end{pmatrix} w.$$

3.1.2. *An integral model.* Consider the lattice $\Lambda := \mathcal{O}_{E_p}^{\oplus 3} \subseteq V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_p$ (with respect to our fixed basis). We will assume that the pairing $\{\cdot,\cdot\}$ restricts to a perfect pairing on Λ (which it does in the explicit cases considered above), and hence G admits a reductive model $\mathcal{G}$ over $\mathbb{Z}_p$. We will use the notation $G(\mathbb{Z}_p) := \mathcal{G}(\mathbb{Z}_p)$, and $G_{\mathbb{F}_p}$ for the reductive special fiber of $\mathcal{G}$. Let $W := \Lambda/p\Lambda$ denote the mod p reduction, and note that we can identify $G_{\mathbb{F}_p} = \mathrm{GU}(W)$ (where W obtains an induced pairing from Λ).

3.1.3. *The maximal torus.* Let $T \subset G$ denote the maximal torus consisting of diagonal matrices with respect to our fixed basis of V. We can identify $T_E \cong \mathbb{G}_m^{\oplus 3} \times \mathbb{G}_m \subseteq \mathrm{GL}(V_{\tau_0}) \times \mathbb{G}_m$, so it is in particular split over E and we can identify $X^*(T) = \mathbb{Z}^{\oplus 3} \times \mathbb{Z}$. To lighten notation, we will sometimes write $(a,b,c) = (a,b,c,0) \in X^*(T)$ when the multiplier component is zero. Since T is not split, $X^*(T)$ comes with a non-trivial Galois action (of the group $\mathrm{Gal}(E/\mathbb{Q})$). One checks that the non-trivial element acts via

$$(a,b,c,d) \longmapsto (-c,-b,-a,a+b+c+d).$$

3.1.4. *The Borel subgroup.* Using that $G_E \cong \mathrm{GL}(V_{\tau_0}) \times \mathbb{G}_{m,E}$, we let $B \subseteq G_E$ denote the upper-triangular Borel subgroup. Note that in the type $(2,1)$-case, our choice of pairing $\{\cdot,\cdot\}$ implies that this Borel descends to $G/\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{Q}$.

3.1.5. *The root datum.* Let R denote the set of roots of G with respect to the torus T. We have the two simple roots $\alpha_1 = (1,-1,0,0)$ and $\alpha_2 = (0,1,-1,0)$, which are furthermore positive with respect to the Borel B fixed above.

Later on, once we fix a Hodge cocharacter, we will have a Levi subgroup $M \subseteq G_E$ (containing T) which depends on the signature (r,s). The roots $\alpha \in R$ that restrict to roots of the Levi M are called the *compact roots*. We let $R_c \subseteq R$ denote the subset of these. The complement of R_c in R, which we denote by R_n, are the *non-compact roots*. The choice of Borel B induces a set of positive roots $R^+ \subseteq R$. We denote by $R_c^+ \subseteq R_c$ and $R_n^+ \subseteq R_n$ for the correpsonding subsets of positive roots. Let $\rho := \frac{1}{2}\sum_{\alpha \in R^+} \alpha$ denote the half-sum of positive roots. We similiarly define $\rho_c := \frac{1}{2}\sum_{\alpha \in R_c^+} \alpha$ and $\rho_n := \frac{1}{2}\sum_{\alpha \in R_n^+} \alpha$.

3.1.6. *The Weyl group.* Let $W(T)$ be the Weyl group acting on T. It is isomorphic to the symmetric group S_3, acting by permuting the basis elements of T. We will let w_0 denote the longest element of the Weyl group, and we let s_i denote the simple reflection corresponding to α_i. In terms of permutations, we can describe these as $w_0 = (13), s_1 = (12), s_2 = (23)$. Once we fix the Levi M, we will let w_c denote the longest element of the Weyl group of M, viewed inside $W(T)$.

3.2. **Unitary Shimura varieties.** Throughout this section we will continue working with a general type (r,s) (with $r+s=3$).

3.2.1. *The integral Shimura datum.* Let $\mathbb{S}$ denote the Deligne torus $\mathrm{Res}_{\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{R}}\mathbb{G}_m$. We can then consider the homomorphism $h : \mathbb{S} \to G_{\mathbb{R}}$ given by $h(z) = \mathrm{diag}(z\mathbf{1}_r, \overline{z}\mathbf{1}_s)$. Combining this with what was done in §3.1, we now have an integral PEL Shimura datum given by $(E, V, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle, h, \Lambda, \mathcal{O}_{E_p})$.

3.2.2. *The Hodge cocharacter.* Associated to h, we can attach the Hodge cocharacter $\mu : \mathbb{G}_{m,E} \to G_E$ given by $\mu(z) = \mathrm{diag}(z\mathbf{1}_r, \mathbf{1}_s) \times z$. Note that its field of definition is E, which will be the reflex field of our Shimura varieties. The stabilizer of μ will be a Levi subgroup which we denote by M. From μ we also obtain a parabolic P, given by

$$P = \{g \in G_E \mid \lim_{t\to 0} \mu(t) g \mu(t)^{-1} \text{ exists}\}.$$

P will be isomorphic to the stabilizer of the corresponding Hodge filtration at any point of our Shimura variety. We will let P^- denote the opposite parabolic. Both P and M can be defined integrally, and we let $P_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$ resp. $M_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$ denote their special fibers. Note that the bulk of this paper

will be taking place in characteristic p, so it will be common to replace P and M with their special fibers to lighten notation (we will make it clear when this applies).

3.2.3. *The moduli space.* We will now define the moduli space corresponding to our integral PEL datum above. These will be defined integrally, as schemes over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{Z}_{p^2}$ (which is isomorphic to $\operatorname{Spec}\mathcal{O}_{E_p}$), and with *hyperspecial* level. Fix an open compact subgroup $K^p \subseteq \mathbb{A}_f^p$, where $\mathbb{A}_f^p$ denotes the finite adeles away from p. Let $K := K^p K_p$, where $K_p = G(\mathbb{Z}_p)$ (i.e. the level is hyperspecial at p).

Let Sh_K denote the moduli problem sending a $\mathbb{Z}_{p^2}$-scheme S to the set of equivalence classes $\{(A, \iota, \lambda, \eta)\}/\sim$ where

(i) $A \to S$ is an abelian scheme.

(ii) The dual abelian scheme $A^\vee$ exists, and $\lambda : A \to A^\vee$ is a prime-to-p quasi-polarization (meaning, it is invertible as an element of $\mathrm{Isog}(A, A^\vee) \otimes \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$).

(iii) $\iota : \mathcal{O}_E \to \mathrm{End}(A) \otimes \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$ is a homomorphism such that for all $x \in \mathcal{O}_E$, we have $\iota(\overline{x}) = \lambda^{-1} \circ \iota(x)^\vee \circ \lambda$. Furthermore, it needs to satisfy the signature condition (r, s), i.e. for all $x \in \mathcal{O}_E$ we have

$$\mathrm{charpol}(\iota(x)|_{\mathrm{Lie}(A)}) = (T - \tau_0(x))^r (T - \tau_1(x))^s.$$

Here we interpret τ_i by fixing an isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{E_p} \cong \mathbb{Z}_{p^2}$.

(iv) η is a K^p-level structure. By this we mean that, for each connected component S_i of S, after fixing a geometric point $s_i \in S_i$, we have some fixed K^p-orbit

$$\eta_i \in K^p \backslash \mathrm{Isom}_{G(\mathbb{A}_f^p)}(V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{A}_f^p, V^p(A_{s_i})).$$

Here, $V^p(A)$ denotes the rational Tate module of A away from p. It comes equipped with the Weil pairing, taking values in $\mathbb{A}_f^p(1)$. The notation $\mathrm{Isom}_{G(\mathbb{A}_f^p)}$ means that we require our automorphisms to respect the $\mathcal{O}_E$-action, and that there is some $\nu(\eta_i)$ making the following diagram commute, where the horizontal arrows are the pairings

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{A}_f^p \times V \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{A}_f^p & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{A}_f^p \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \eta_i \times \eta_i} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \nu(\eta_i)} \\ V^p(A_{s_i}) \times V^p(A_{s_i}) & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{A}_f^p(1) \end{array}$$

Finally, we require that the K^p-orbit η_i is $\pi_1(S_i, s_i)$-stable.

By equivalence classes, we mean that we identify tuples $(A_i, \iota_i, \lambda_i, \eta_i)$ for $i = 0, 1$, if there exists a prime-to-p quasi-isogeny $A_1 \dashrightarrow A_2$ preserving the $\mathcal{O}_E$ action, and the K^p-level structure, as well as preserving the polarization λ up to a $\mathrm{Cont}(S, \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}^\times)$-scalar. We will refer to a triple (A, ι, λ) as a principally polarized unitary abelian variety (of signature (r, s)).

Note that (iii) implies that the relative dimension of A must be 3.

For small enough K^p, this moduli problem is representable by a smooth, quasi-projective scheme over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{Z}_{p^2}$ of relative dimension rs [Kot92, §5]. In the case $rs = 0$, we will refer to Sh_K as a *Shimura set*, and otherwise we will refer to it as a Shimura variety.

3.2.4. *Adelic double quotients.* Since G satisfies the Hasse principle[1], the complex points of Sh_K admit a description as an adelic double quotient

$$\mathrm{Sh}_K(\mathbb{C}) = G(\mathbb{Q}) \backslash (X \times G(\mathbb{A}_f)/K).$$

Here X denotes the $G(\mathbb{R})$-conjugacy class of h. Notice that for $rs = 0$, X is just a point.

[1]By [Kot92, §7] this reduces to $\mathrm{Res}_{E/\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{G}_m$, for which it holds by the Hasse norm theorem.

3.3. **Automorphic vector bundles.** Throughout this section, we will be working over the base $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$, as our results only concern automorphic vector bundles in characteristic p anyways. To avoid cluttering the notation too much, we will therefore consider all schemes to be implicitly base changed to $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$. In particular, T will be split in this section.

3.3.1. *Construction.* Let $(\mathcal{A}, \iota, \lambda, \eta)$ denote the universal family over Sh_K. It admits a Hodge filtration, which is determined by its τ_0-isotypic component

$$0 \longrightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}^\vee)_{\tau_0} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Consider the space of trivializations

$$G_{dR} := \underline{\mathrm{Isom}}_{\mathrm{Sh}_K}(\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}, W_{\tau_0} \otimes_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathrm{Sh}_K}).$$

By [Zha18, Theorem 3.4.1], $G_{dR} \to \mathrm{Sh}_K$ is a (left) étale G-torsor. It admits a natural morphism to the flag space G/P, given by applying a given trivialization Φ to the Hodge filtration. This gives us a pullback square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G_{dR} & \longrightarrow & G/P \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{Sh}_K & \longrightarrow & [*/P]\,. \end{array}$$

Let $\mathrm{Rep}(P)$ denote the category of finite dimensional algebraic P-representations, and for an algebraic stack $\mathfrak{X}$, we will let $VB(\mathfrak{X})$ denote the corresponding category of finite rank vector bundles. Then we get a functor from the above square via pullback

$$\omega : \mathrm{Rep}(P) \cong VB([*/P]) \longrightarrow VB(\mathrm{Sh}_K).$$

The image of this functor will be the *automorphic vector bundles* on Sh_K.

We are particularly interested in automorphic vector bundles induced from the torus $T \subseteq M$. Namely, given a character $\lambda \in X^*(T)$, we get the induced representation $\mathrm{Ind}_{M\cap B}^M w_c\lambda$ of the Levi M, which we can then inflate to a representation of P. This gives us a map which we again denote by

$$\omega : X^*(T) \longrightarrow VB(\mathrm{Sh}_K).$$

Given $\lambda \in X^*(T)$ we will say that $\omega(\lambda)$ is the automorphic vector bundle of *coherent weight* λ. The weights of the form $\lambda = (a, b, b-2, d)$ with $a \geq b$ will be the *irregular* weights.

Let us also introduce the notation $\delta := \omega(0,0,0,1)$, and $\det := \omega(1,1,1,0)$, corresponding to the multiplier resp. the determinant characters of G (restricted to P). They are trivial as line bundles, but come with non-trivial Hecke actions.

3.4. **Unitary flag Shimura varieties.** As of recently, the so-called *flag Shimura varieties*, have become an indispensable tool in the study of special fibers of Shimura varieties. The reason being that, by working on flag Shimura varieties, the cohomology of automorphic vector bundles on Sh_K reduces to the cohomology of certain automorphic line bundles on the flag Shimura variety. There is also an analogue of the Ekedahl-Oort filtration on flag Shimura varieties which is much more well-behaved. Let us introduce these now. For simplicity, we will continue working over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$ in this section.

Fix a parabolic $Q \subseteq P$, then we define $\mathcal{F}l_{K,Q}$ as the pullback

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}l_{K,Q} & \longrightarrow & [*/Q] \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_Q} & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{Sh}_K & \longrightarrow & [*/P]\,. \end{array}$$

From now on set $Q = B$ (we will return to $Q \neq B$ in §3.8.7). In this case, we will omit the B-subscript from the notation. The variety $\mathcal{F}l_K$ admits a moduli interpretation as follows. Given a

scheme S over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$, $\mathcal{F}l_K(S)$ can be described as the set of equivalence classes $(A,\lambda,\iota,\eta,\mathrm{Fil})$ where $(A,\lambda,\iota,\eta)\in \mathrm{Sh}_K(S)$ and Fil is an (increasing) refinement of the Hodge filtration given by

$$\mathrm{Fil}\,:\,0=\mathcal{F}_0\subseteq\mathcal{F}_1\subseteq\mathcal{F}_2\subseteq\mathcal{F}_3=\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)_{\tau_0},$$

where $\mathcal{F}_r=\omega_{A,\tau_0}$. Note that $\mathcal{F}l_K$ is of dimension 3, regardless of the signature (r,s). It is instead the dimension of the fibers of π that varies with the signature.

3.4.1. *Automorphic line bundles.* The map $\mathcal{F}l_K\to[*/B]$ induces a functor

$$\mathrm{Rep}(B)\longrightarrow VB(\mathcal{F}l_K).$$

Given a character $\lambda\in X^*(T)$, by first twisting by w_c, and then inflating it to a representation of B, we obtain a map

$$\mathcal{L}:X^*(T)\xrightarrow{w_c}X^*(T)\longrightarrow\mathrm{Rep}(B)\longrightarrow VB(\mathcal{F}l_K).$$

The image of this functor takes values in line bundles, since the corresponding representation of B is a character. The reason for introducing the twist by w_c above is to have

$$\pi_*\mathcal{L}(\lambda)=\omega(\lambda).$$

3.5. **The Hodge and conjugate filtrations.** As a preliminary for introducing the so-called coarse stratification on our flag Shimura varieties, let us discuss the Hodge and conjugate filtration of the universal abelian variety $\mathcal{A}$ in characteristic p. Throughout this subsection we will be working over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$.

3.5.1. *Orthogonal complements.* Given a subbundle $\mathcal{E}\subseteq\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}$ over $\mathcal{F}l_K$, let $\mathcal{E}^\perp$ denote the kernel of the following composition

$$\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}\xrightarrow{\sim}\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})^{**}_{\tau_0}\twoheadrightarrow\lambda(\mathcal{E})^*\otimes\delta.$$

Here we insert a twist by δ (which is trivial as a line bundle), so that the orthogonal complement is compatible with the corresponding operation on B-subrepresentations of W_{τ_0} under the morphism $\mathcal{F}l_K\to[*/B]$. We will sometimes refer back to the following basic linear algebra lemma.

Lemma 3.1. *Given a morphism $\Phi:\mathcal{E}\to\mathcal{F}$ of vector bundles on some scheme S, and a subbundle $\mathcal{G}\subseteq\mathcal{F}$. Then we have that*

$$\Phi^*(\mathcal{G}^*)=(\Phi^{-1}(\mathcal{G})/\ker\Phi)^*.$$

Proof. By considering the restriction $\Phi|_{\Phi^{-1}(\mathcal{G})}$, this reduces to $\mathcal{G}=\mathcal{F}$. The lemma now follows from the fact that $\operatorname{Im}\Phi^*=(\operatorname{Im}\Phi)^*$. □

Corollary 3.2. *For any subbundle $\mathcal{E}\subseteq\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_i}$, we can characterize $\mathcal{E}^\perp$ as the following kernel*

$$0\longrightarrow\mathcal{E}^\perp\longrightarrow\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_{i+1}}\longrightarrow\lambda^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^*)\longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. Let us implicitly identify $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_{i+1}}\cong\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})^{**}_{\tau_{i+1}}$ in this proof. The fact that $-\lambda=\lambda^*$ and Lemma 3.1 gives us the following chain of equalities, from which the corollary follows

$$\lambda(\mathcal{E})^*=-\lambda(\mathcal{E})^*=\lambda^*(\mathcal{E})^*=\lambda^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^*).$$

□

Corollary 3.3. *For any subbundle $\mathcal{E}\subseteq\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_i}$, we have an isomorphism $\mathcal{E}^{\perp,\perp}\cong\mathcal{E}$ of subbundles in $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_i}$.*

Proof. The above corollary implies that $\lambda(\mathcal{E}^\perp)^*\cong\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_i}/\mathcal{E}$, from which the desired isomorphism easily follows by unfolding the definition of $\mathcal{E}^{\perp,\perp}$. □

Taking the orthogonal complement of Fil, gives us the following filtration

$$\mathrm{Fil}^{\perp} \,:\, 0 = \mathcal{F}_3^{\perp} \subseteq \mathcal{F}_2^{\perp} \subseteq \mathcal{F}_1^{\perp} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_1}.$$

We have the following comparison isomorphisms between the graded pieces of the two filtrations.

Lemma 3.4. *For each $i = 0, 1, 2$, there is an isomorphism of line bundles*

$$\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp}/\mathcal{F}_{i+1}^{\perp} \cong (\mathcal{F}_{i+1}/\mathcal{F}_i)^* \otimes \delta$$

Proof. By untangling the definition, we obtain the following chain of isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp}/\mathcal{F}_{i+1}^{\perp} &\cong \ker(\lambda(\mathcal{F}_{i+1})^* \otimes \delta \twoheadrightarrow \lambda(\mathcal{F}_i)^* \otimes \delta) \\ &\cong (\lambda(\mathcal{F}_{i+1})/\lambda(\mathcal{F}_i))^* \otimes \delta \\ &\cong (\mathcal{F}_{i+1}/\mathcal{F}_i)^* \otimes \delta.\end{aligned}$$

□

Together, Fil and $\mathrm{Fil}^{\perp}$ assemble to an extension of the Hodge filtration of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)$.

3.5.2. *The conjugate filtration.* On Sh_K, we have an *increasing* conjugate filtration given by

$$0 \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}.$$

Note that it is common to view the conjugate filtration as decreasing, however since we are taking τ_0-isotypic components it is more convenient to view it as an increasing filtration (it makes the comparison in Lemmas 3.5 and 3.6 as clean as possible). There are comparison isomorphisms between the graded pieces of the conjugate filtration, and the graded pieces of the (p)-twisted τ_1-isotypic component of the Hodge filtration. These are given by

$$V : \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}/(\ker V)_{\tau_0} \xrightarrow{\sim} \omega_{\tau_1}^{(p)} \text{ and } F : (\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)_{\tau_1}/\omega_{\tau_1})^{(p)} \xrightarrow{\sim} (\ker V)_{\tau_0}. \tag{1}$$

In particular, notice that $(\ker V)_{\tau_0}$ is locally free of rank r. These two filtrations, along with the isomorphisms between the graded pieces, give $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})$ the structure of a G-zip (see §3.6.1). We now want to extend the conjugate filtration to a full filtration on the flag Shimura variety. For this purpose, we define

$$\mathcal{G}^i := \begin{cases} F(\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp,(p)}) & \text{for } 0 \leq i \leq r, \\ V^{-1}(\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp,(p)}) & \text{for } r \leq i \leq r+s. \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

Note that this is well defined in the overlapping boundary case, and that it induces *decreasing* filtrations on $(\ker V)_{\tau_0}$ and $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}/(\ker V)_{\tau_0}$. Again, the ordering is chosen to make certain comparison isomorphisms as clean as possible to state. We denote this filtration by $\mathrm{Fil}_{conj} := \mathcal{G}^{\bullet}$.

The following lemma describes the graded pieces of Fil_{conj} in terms of the graded pieces of Fil.

Lemma 3.5. *We have isomorphisms*

$$\mathcal{G}^i/\mathcal{G}^{i+1} \cong (\mathcal{F}_{i+1}/\mathcal{F}_i)^{\otimes -p} \otimes \delta^{\otimes p}$$

for all $0 \leq i \leq r+s$.

Proof. Since $(\ker F)_{\tau_1} = (\mathrm{Im}\, V)_{\tau_1} = \omega_{\tau_1}^{(p)}$, this is clear from the definition of $\mathcal{G}^{\bullet}$ and Lemma 3.4. □

We can again take orthogonal complements to obtain the filtration $\mathrm{Fil}_{conj}^{\perp}$, which together with Fil_{conj} assembles to a refinement of the conjugate filtration on $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)$.

The following lemma shows that $\mathrm{Fil}_{conj}^{\perp}$ can also be obtained analogously to (2).

Lemma 3.6. *For any subbundle $\mathcal{E} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)_{\tau_i}$, we have that*

$$F(\mathcal{E}^{\perp,(p)}) = V^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^{(p)})^{\perp}.$$

In particular we get that

$$\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp} = \begin{cases} V^{-1}(\mathcal{F}_i^{(p)}) & \text{for } 0 \leq i \leq r, \\ F(\mathcal{F}_i^{(p)}) & \text{for } r \leq i \leq r+s. \end{cases}$$

Proof. First, Corollary 3.2 implies that

$$F(\mathcal{E}^{\perp,(p)}) = \ker\left(F(\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)^{(p)}_{\tau_{i+1}}) \longrightarrow F(\lambda^{(p),-1}(\mathcal{E}^{*,(p)}))\right). \tag{3}$$

Recall that $\lambda \circ F = V^* \circ \lambda^{(p)}$. Hence $F(\lambda^{(p),-1}(\mathcal{E}^{*,(p)})) = \lambda^{-1}(V^*(\mathcal{E}^{*,(p)}))$. Now Lemma 3.1 implies that $V^*(\mathcal{E}^{*,(p)}) = (V^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^{(p)})/(\ker V)_{\tau_{i+1}})^*$. Thus we can consider the following commutative diagram, with all rows and columns known to be exact, except the middle row. The exactness of the top row follows from (3), and the exactness of the middle column follows from $(\ker V)^{\perp}_{\tau_i} = (\ker V)_{\tau_{i+1}}$.

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
 & & 0 & & 0 & & 0 & & \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & F(\mathcal{E}^{\perp,(p)}) & \longrightarrow & (\ker V)_{\tau_i} & \longrightarrow & \lambda^{-1}(V^*(\mathcal{E}^{*,(p)})) & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & F(\mathcal{E}^{\perp,(p)}) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(A)_{\tau_i} & \longrightarrow & \lambda^{-1}((V^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^{(p)})^*) & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & 0 & \longrightarrow & \lambda^{-1}((\ker V)^*_{\tau_{i+1}}) & \longrightarrow & \lambda^{-1}((\ker V)^*_{\tau_{i+1}}) & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
 & & & & 0 & & 0 & &
\end{array}$$

The middle row is exact by the 9-lemma, from which $F(\mathcal{E}^{\perp,(p)}) = V^{-1}(\mathcal{E}^{(p)})^{\perp}$ follows. □

3.6. **The coarse stratification.** In characteristic p, flag Shimura varieties admit a well-behaved stratification known as the *coarse stratification* [GK19b]. It can be thought of as a generalization of the classical a-number stratification of a Shimura variety. There is also an analogue of the Ekedahl-Oort stratification on (partial) flag Shimura varieties, but when $Q = B$ it coincides with the coarse stratification.

In this subsection, let us give a brief indication of the general theory of this stratification, and its relation to the stack of G-zips, and more generally G-zipflags (see [GK19b]). Let us remark that once we specialize to the type $(2,1)$ and $(3,0)$-case, we will be able to give concrete description of these strata (and the partial Hasse invariants), independent of the theory of G-zips. Hence, an understanding of stacks of G-zips will not be necessary for reading this paper. However, we still find it useful to introduce these stacks, as some of the references we use will be written in this language, and because it makes the argument in the beginning of §5 cleaner.

Throughout this subsection we continue to work over $\operatorname{Spec} \mathbb{F}_{p^2}$.

3.6.1. *The stack of G-zips.* Consider the algebraic group

$$E := \left\{(x,y) \in P \times P^{-,(p)} \mid \varphi(\overline{x}) = \overline{y}\right\}.$$

Here $\overline{x}$ denotes the projection of x to the Levi $M \subseteq P$ (resp. to $M^{(p)} \subseteq P^{-,(p)}$), and $\varphi : M \to M^{(p)}$ denotes the Frobenius homomorphism. From this, we can define the stack of G-zips as

$$\text{G-Zip}^{\mu} := [E \backslash G].$$

This stack turns out to parametrize objects known as G-zips. Informally, a G-zip should be thought of as a G-torsor V, equipped with two filtrations $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ and $\mathcal{G}^\bullet$ (whose types are determined by P resp. P^-), as well as a Frobenius semi-linear isomorphism between their associated graded objects. We have already seen an example of such an object: $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})$ equipped with the Hodge and the conjugate filtration, as well as the isomorphisms from (1). This is the only example we will care about. It follows from [Zha18] that this induces a smooth morphism $\zeta : \mathrm{Sh}_K \to \text{G-Zip}^\mu$, through which $\mathrm{Sh}_K \to [*/P]$ factors. In particular, we can obtain the automorphic vector bundles via pullback from G-Zip$^\mu$. The stack of G-zips is zero-dimensional, and one of the main motivations for introducing it is that its points (and their closure relations) recover the Ekedahl-Oort stratification after pullback via ζ.

We will also need an analogue of G-Zip$^\mu$ for the flag Shimura varieties. Given a parabolic $Q \subseteq P$, we can define G-ZipFlag$^{\mu,Q}$ via pullback

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{G-ZipFlag}^{\mu,Q} & \longrightarrow & [*/Q] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \text{G-Zip}^\mu & \longrightarrow & [*/P]\,. \end{array}$$

This stack parametrizes so-called G-zipflags, which by definition are G-zips equipped with a refinement of the Hodge filtration. As usual, we will omit Q from the notation when $Q = B$. As an immediate consequence of the definition, we also get the following pullback square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}l_{K,Q} & \longrightarrow & \text{G-ZipFlag}^{\mu,Q} \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi} & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{Sh}_K & \longrightarrow & \text{G-Zip}^\mu\,. \end{array}$$

It follows as in §3.5.2, that given a refinement of the Hodge filtration, we can define a suitable refinement of the conjugate filtration. Given a G-zipflag, we will abusively let $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ (or Fil) denote its refined Hodge filtration (i.e. the one of type Q), and we let $\mathcal{G}^\bullet$ (or Fil_{conj}) denote the induced refinement of the conjugate filtration.

3.6.2. *The coarse stratification.* There is a well-behaved stratification on G-ZipFlag$^{\mu,Q}$ (and hence on $\mathcal{F}l_{K,Q}$), given by measuring the relative position between $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ and $\mathcal{G}^\bullet$. Let us explain this only in the case $Q = B$ for simplicity. The stratification can be obtained geometrically from the following morphism of stacks

$$\text{G-ZipFlag}^\mu \longrightarrow [B\backslash G/B],$$

given by sending a G-zipflag to the relative position of $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ and $\mathcal{G}^\bullet \cdot z$, where $z := w_0 w_c$ (viewed as an element in G). The point of z is to conjugate $\mathcal{G}^\bullet$ to have the same stabilizer as $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$. The strata on G-ZipFlag$^\mu$ are then given as the preimages of points in $[B\backslash G/B]$, which by the Bruhat decomposition correspond (uniquely) to double cosets BwB for $w \in W(T)$. It is well-known that $\overline{BwB} = \cup_{w' \leq w} Bw'B$, where the order is given by the Bruhat order on $W(T)$. Thus the closure relations between the strata are exactly determined by the Bruhat order on $W(T)$.

Given $w \in W(T)$ we will let $\mathcal{C}_w$ denote the correpsonding stratum in G-ZipFlag$^\mu$ (i.e. the preimage of BwB), and we will let $\overline{\mathcal{C}}_w$ denote its closure. Let $\mathcal{Z}_w \subseteq \mathcal{F}l_K$ denote the preimage of $\mathcal{C}_w$, and we let $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_w$ denote its closure. From [GK19b, Proposition 6.3.1] we have that $\mathcal{Z}_w$ has dimension $\ell(w)$. It follows from the explicit description of $W(T) \cong S_3$, together with its Bruhat order, that our flag Shimura variety $\mathcal{F}l_K$ will have 6 strata: one 3-dimensional stratum, two 2-dimensional, two 1-dimensional, and one 0-dimensional stratum. Each closed stratum of a given dimension contains all strata of strictly smaller dimension.

3.6.3. *Partial Hasse invariants.* The coarse stratification satisfies the property that for each $w \in W$, each codimension 1 stratum $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{w'} \subseteq \overline{\mathcal{Z}}_w$ is given by the vanishing of a section of some line bundle over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_w$. Such sections are known as *partial Hasse invariants*. We will be able to explicitly write these down whenever we need to use them, so we will not go much into the general theory.

3.7. **The Shimura variety of type** $(2,1)$**.** Let us now specialize the above theory to the case $(r,s) = (2,1)$. From now on, we will reuse the notation from the general type (r,s) setting in the type $(2,1)$ case, and we will add a prime $'$ to denote corresponding object in the $(3,0)$ case (which will be discussed in §3.8). In particular, we will let let $(E, V, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle, h, \mathcal{O}_{E_p}, \Lambda)$ denote the integral Shimura datum in the type $(2,1)$ case, and G will denote the associated group. Fix a small enough level structure $K = K^p K_p \subseteq G(\mathbb{A}_f)$ that is hyperspecial at p.

For the remainder of this paper, we will be working in characteristic p. Therefore, let us use Sh_K to denote the special fiber of the integral model of level K. We let $\mathcal{A}$ denote the associated universal abelian variety, and we write $\mathcal{F}l_K$ for the corresponding flag Shimura variety (over $\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$).

3.7.1. *Some group theory.* In the type $(2,1)$-case our Hodge cocharacter μ is given by $z \mapsto \operatorname{diag}(z,z,1)\times z$. Thus, the Levi M is given by the subgroup of matrices of the form

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & 0 \\ * & * & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \times (*),$$

and P will consist of matrices of the form

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * \\ * & * & * \\ 0 & 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \times (*).$$

3.7.2. *The filtrations.* In the type $(2,1)$-case, we will write the Hodge filtration Fil on $\mathcal{F}l_K$ as

$$0 \subseteq \mathcal{F} \subseteq \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}.$$

We will reserve the notation $\mathcal{F}_i$ for the type $(3,0)$-case (since the above filtration will not be used much after the setup, we hope that no confusion will occur). The conjugate filtration Fil_{conj} is then given by

$$0 \subseteq \mathcal{G} := F(\mathcal{F}^{\perp,(p)}) \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}. \tag{4}$$

3.7.3. *Automorphic vector bundles.* The parabolic P induces a 2-dimensional $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$-subspace $F \subseteq W_{\tau_0}$. This allows us to identify $M \cong \mathrm{GL}(F) \times \mathrm{GL}(W_{\tau_0}/F) \times \mathbb{G}_{m,\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$. With this identification, we get the following description for dominant $\lambda = (a,b,c,d)$ (i.e. $a \geq b$)

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{M\cap B}^{M} w_c\lambda \cong \mathrm{Sym}^{a-b} F \otimes (\det F)^{\otimes b} \otimes (W_{\tau_0}/F)^{\otimes c} \otimes \delta^{\otimes d}.$$

It then follows that (for λ dominant)

$$\omega(\lambda) \cong \mathrm{Sym}^{a-b} \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \otimes (\det \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0})^{\otimes b} \otimes (\mathrm{Lie}\, \mathcal{A}^\vee)_{\tau_0}^{\otimes c} \otimes \delta^{\otimes d}.$$

3.7.4. *Automorphic line bundles.* Tracing through the construction of the automorphic line bundles given above (and being mindful of the twist by w_c), we get the following description in terms of the graded pieces of Fil

$$\mathcal{L}(a,b,c,d) \cong (\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}/\mathcal{F})^{\otimes a} \otimes \mathcal{F}^{\otimes b} \otimes (\mathrm{Lie}\, \mathcal{A}^\vee)_{\tau_0}^{\otimes c} \otimes \delta^{\otimes d}. \tag{5}$$

for any $(a,b,c,d) \in X^*(T)$.

3.7.5. *Closed strata and partial Hasse invariants.* We have two closed (coarse) strata of codimension 1, given by the conditions $\mathcal{F} \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0}$ resp. $\mathcal{G} \subseteq \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}$. One can check that these correspond to the elements $s_2 s_1 = (132)$ resp. $s_1 s_2 = (123)$ of $W(T) = S_3$, so we will label these by $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{21}$ resp. $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}$. Notice that these are given by the vanishing loci of the projection morphisms

$$\mathrm{ha}_{21} : \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}/(\ker V)_{\tau_0},$$

resp.

$$\mathrm{ha}_{12} : \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}/\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}.$$

Note that after re-arranging (and applying Lemma 3.5), we can consider these as sections of automorphic line bundles: $\mathrm{ha}_{21} \in \mathcal{L}(0,-1,-p,p)(\mathcal{F}l_K)$ and $\mathrm{ha}_{12} \in \mathcal{L}(p,0,1,-p)(\mathcal{F}l_K)$.

There are two coarse strata in $\mathcal{F}l_K$ of codimension 2. They are defined by the closed conditions $\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0}$ resp. $\mathcal{F} \subseteq \mathcal{G}$. Again, one may check that these correspond to the elements s_1 resp. s_2 in $W(T)$, so we will denote them by $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ resp. $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$. Notice that, since these are containments of subbundles of the same rank, they are actually equalities. Considering both of these strata as subvarieties of $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}$, we get corresponding partial hasse invariants

$$\mathrm{ha}_1 : (\ker V)_{\tau_0}/\mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})_{\tau_0}/\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}$$

and

$$\mathrm{ha}_2 : \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0}/\mathcal{F}.$$

We can also consider these as global sections of $\mathcal{L}(0,p,1,-p)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}}$ resp. $\mathcal{L}(p+1,0,0,-p)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}}$.

Lemma 3.7. *We have* $\mathrm{div}(\mathrm{ha}_i) = -\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_i$ *for* $i \in \{21,12,1,2\}$*, where we view* ha_i *as a section over* $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}$ *when* $i \in \{1,2\}$*.*

Proof. It is clear that these sections can be obtained via pullback from $[B\backslash G/B]$ (their definition only depends on the two filtrations and their relative positions). Next, since the morphism $\mathcal{F}l_K \to [B\backslash G/B]$ is smooth, it follows that it suffices to compute the corresponding divisors on $[B\backslash G/B]$. This can be done by combining Theorem 2.2.1c) and Lemma 3.1.1b) in [GK19a]. □

We will say that an abelian variety is superspecial if it is isomorphic to a product of supersingular elliptic curves.

Lemma 3.8. *The stratum* $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ *is a* $\mathbb{P}^1$*-bundle over the* 0*-dimensional superspecial locus of* $\mathrm{Sh}_{K,\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$*.*

Proof. Notice that the condition $\omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0}$ is independent of the subbundle $\mathcal{F}$. Hence, we already get that $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ must be a $\mathbb{P}^1$-bundle over some locus in the base $\mathrm{Sh}_{K,\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$. Next, it follows by taking orthogonal complements that the condition defining $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ is equivalent to demanding $\omega_A = \ker V$. It follows from [Oor75, Theorem 2] that this condition is equivalent to the abelian variety being superspecial. □

3.8. **The Shimura set of type** $(3,0)$**.** Let $(E, V, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle', h', \mathcal{O}_{E_p}, \Lambda)$ denote the integral PEL datum in the type $(3,0)$ case, and let G' denote the associated group. Since we are working in odd dimension, there is only one unitary group over a local non-archimedean field. In particular, we have that $G_{\mathbb{Q}_\ell} \cong G'_{\mathbb{Q}_\ell}$ for all primes ℓ. Thus, we can pick a level $K' \subseteq G'(\mathbb{A}_f) \cong G(\mathbb{A}_f)$ corresponding to K. Let $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$ denote the special fiber of the corresponding Shimura set of level K'. Since $G'_{\mathbb{Q}_p} \cong G_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$, we will generallly replace $G'_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$ (and its special fiber) with $G_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$ (resp. $G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$)) in what follows. In this setting, the stabilizer of the Hodge cocharacter (over $\mathrm{Spec}\,\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$) is then just given by $P' = G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$, and the corresponding Levi is then again $G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$. We let $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$ denote the special fiber of the corresponding flag Shimura variety, and $\mathcal{A}'$ denote the universal abelian variety.

3.8.1. *Abelian varieties of type* $(3,0)$. Fix an abelian variety A of type $(3,0)$ over a field k' in characteristic p. The signature condition implies in particular that $\omega_A = \omega_{A,\tau_0} = (\ker V)_{\tau_0} = \ker V$. Thus A must be superspecial.

It follows from [FHI24, Proposition 2.1.2.] that there exists some supersingular elliptic curve E, and some self-dual $\mathcal{O}_{E_p}$-Hermitian lattice Λ_0 such that $\mathcal{D}(A) \cong \mathcal{D}(E) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{E_p}} \Lambda_0$. In particular, we deduce from the case of supersingular elliptic curves that $F^{-1,(p)} \circ V = \sigma^2 : \mathcal{D}(A) \to \mathcal{D}(A)^{(p^2)}$ and $V^{-1,(p)} \circ F = \sigma^{-2} : \mathcal{D}(A)^{(p^2)} \to \mathcal{D}(A)$.

3.8.2. *Automorphic vector bundles.* In the type $(3,0)$-setting, the automorphic vector bundles are obtained via pullback from $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'} \to [*/G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}]$. For a representation $\sigma \in \mathrm{Rep}(G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}})$, we let $\omega'(\sigma)$ denote the associated automorphic vector bundle. For a character $\lambda \in X^*(T)$ we let $\omega'(\lambda)$ denote the automorphic vector bundle of coherent weight $\lambda \in X^*(T)$ as before. Notice that $\omega'(\lambda) = \omega'(W(\lambda))$, where $W(\lambda)$ denotes the dual Weyl module associated to λ. By using the description of the Shimura set $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$ as an adelic double quotient, one may show that for any $\sigma \in \mathrm{Rep}(G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}})$, we have

$$H^0(\omega'(\sigma), \mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}) = \{f : G'(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G'(\mathbb{A}_f)/K'^p \to \sigma : f(gk) = k^{-1}f(g) \quad \forall g \in G'(\mathbb{A}_f), k \in K'_p\}.$$

Thus, global sections of automorphic vector bundles for Shimura sets are just spaces of algebraic automorphic forms in the sense of [Gro99].

3.8.3. *Automorphic line bundles.* We will use the notation $\mathcal{L}'(a,b,c,d)$ for the automorphic line bundles in this case.

3.8.4. *The filtrations.* In the type $(3,0)$-case, we have the following Hodge and conjugate filtrations.

$$\mathrm{Fil} \,:\, 0 \subseteq \mathcal{F}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{F}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{F}_3 = \omega_{\mathcal{A},\tau_0} = \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')_{\tau_0}$$

and

$$\mathrm{Fil}_{conj} \,:\, 0 \subseteq F(\mathcal{F}_2^{\perp}) \subseteq F(\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp}) \subseteq (\ker V)_{\tau_0} = \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')_{\tau_0}.$$

We will use the notation $\mathcal{G}^i = F(\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp,(p)})$ as before. The following lemma shows that, in the type $(3,0)$ case, we can completely describe the action of F and V on the two filtrations

Lemma 3.9. *We have that*

(i) $V(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp}) = \mathcal{F}_i^{(p)}$
(ii) $F(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp,(p)}) = \mathcal{F}_i$
(iii) $F(\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp,(p)}) = \mathcal{G}^i$
(iv) $V(\mathcal{F}_i^{\perp}) = \mathcal{G}^{i,(p)}$

Proof. (i) follows from Lemma 3.6, and (iii) is true by definition. Let us now prove (ii). Recall that $V^{-1} \circ F^{(p)} = \sigma^{-2} : \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')^{(p^2)}_{\tau_1} \to \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')_{\tau_1}$. Thus $V^{-1} \circ F^{(p)}(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp,(p^2)}) = \mathcal{G}^{i,\perp}$. Applying V to both sides, combined with (i), gives

$$(F(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp,(p)}))^{(p)} = F^{(p)}(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp,(p^2)}) = V(\mathcal{G}^{i,\perp}) = \mathcal{F}_i^{(p)}.$$

Thus, by untwisting, we obtain (ii). Finally, (iv) follows from the same argument using (iii) instead of (i) (but this time we do not even need to untwist). □

3.8.5. *The stratification.* We will mainly be interested in two of the closed coarse strata in $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. The first stratum is defined by the codimension 1 condition

$$\mathcal{F}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{G}^1.$$

This stratum corresponds to the element $s_2s_1 = (132)$ in $W(T)$. Let us denote it by $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21} \subset \mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. Next, we consider the codimension 2 stratum given by

$$\mathcal{F}_2 = \mathcal{G}^1.$$

This corresponds to the element $s_1 \in W(T)$, so we denote it by $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$. Note that it is contained in $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$ (of codimension 1). Notice that the equality $\mathcal{F}_2 = \mathcal{G}^1$ over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ gives us an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{G}^0/\mathcal{G}^1 \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2.$$

After tensoring by $(\mathcal{G}^0/\mathcal{G}^1)^{\otimes -1}$ on both sides, we obtain an invertible section $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{L}(1,0,p,-p)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$. This can be viewed as an "invertible partial Hasse invariant", and will allow us to shift the weight by multiples of $(1,0,p,-p)$ without affecting the isomorphism class of the line bundle on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$.

Let us also write $\overline{\mathcal{C}}'_i$ to denote the closed stratum of G-ZipFlag$^{\mu'}$ corresponding to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_i$, and $\mathcal{C}'_i$ for the unique open stratum contained in $\overline{\mathcal{C}}'_i$.

3.8.6. *Relation to Deligne-Lusztig varieties.* There is a close relation between the coarse stratification on $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$ and the Deligne-Lusztig stratification on G/B, as we now explain. Recall the $\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$-Hermitian space $W = \Lambda/p\Lambda$. The above discussion on stratifications then applies equally to the flag variety $G/B = \mathrm{GU}(W)_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}/B$, after replacing $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')$ with W, and replacing the Frobenius morphism $F_{\mathcal{A}}$ acting on the Hodge filtration $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ by the Frobenius of $\mathrm{GU}(W)_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$ acting on the quotient $\mathrm{GU}(W)_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}/B$. In particular, we obtain a morhpism $G/B \to \text{G-ZipFlag}^{\mu'}$. Let X_w be the preimage of $\mathcal{C}'_w$. This gives a stratification of G/B, and the strata X_w for $w \in W(T)$ are exactly the Deligne-Lusztig varieties. We will let $\overline{X}_i$ denote the closed stratum corresponding to $\overline{\mathcal{C}}'_i$.

Remark 3.10. Since $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$ is just a disjoint union of flag varieties G/B, it follows that $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_i$ is just a disjoint union of closed Deligne-Lusztig varieties isomorphic to $\overline{X}_i$.

3.8.7. *The partial flag variety.* An important result in this paper is the computation of global sections of certain automorphic line bundles on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$. For this computation, it will be more convenient to realize $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ as a codimension 1 stratum inside a partial flag Shimura variety (as opposed to a codimension 2 stratum in the full flag Shimura variety). Let $P^* \subseteq G_{\mathbb{F}_{p^2}}$ denote the parabolic consisting of matrices of the form

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * \\ 0 & * & * \\ 0 & * & * \end{pmatrix} \times (*).$$

The Hodge filtration on the corresponding flag Shimura variety $\mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$ is then given by

$$\mathrm{Fil} : 0 \subseteq \mathcal{F}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{F}_3 = \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}')_{\tau_0}.$$

If we let $\mathbb{P}^{2,*}$ denote the projective space parametrizing 2-dimensional quotients (we reserve $\mathbb{P}^2$ to denote the space parametrizing 1-dimensional quotients, as is more standard), then $\mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$ is just given by a disjoint union of varieties isomorphism to $\mathbb{P}^{2,*}$.

There is a projection map $\pi_{B,P^*} : \mathcal{F}l'_{K'} \to \mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$ given by sending $\mathcal{F}_\bullet$ to $\mathcal{F}_1$. By abuse of notation, this restricts to a closed immersion $\pi_{B,P^*} : \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$. Indeed, the map is proper, and since $\mathcal{F}_2 = \mathcal{G}^1$ on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$, we see that $\mathcal{F}_2$ is uniquely determined from $\mathcal{F}_1$, so the map is also a monomorphism. Hence we can (and will) also treat $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ as a closed codimension 1 stratum inside $\mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$.

Remark 3.11. It follows from the same argument that the corresponding closed Deligne-Lusztig variety $\overline{X}_1$ can be identified with a closed subvariety of G/P^*. This is exactly (at least after replacing P^* by P) the generalized Deligne-Lusztig variety considered in [Vol10].

We can also consider automorphic vector bundles on $\mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$. In particular, we will be interested in the line bundles

$$\mathcal{L}'_{P^*}(a,a,b,d) := \det(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1)^{\otimes a} \otimes \mathcal{F}_1^{\otimes b} \otimes \delta^{\otimes d}.$$

Notice that $\pi^*_{B,P^*}\mathcal{L}'_{P^*}(a,a,b,d) \cong \mathcal{L}'(a,a,b,d)$.

4. Geometric Jacquet-Langlands

In this section we describe the geometric Jacquet-Langlands phenomenon, relating the unitary Shimura variety of type $(2,1)$ to the unitary Shimura set of type $(3,0)$, by identifying the two 1-dimensional strata $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ and $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$.

4.1. **The family of isogenies over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$.** Recall that $\mathcal{A}'$ denotes the universal abelian variety over $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. Our goal is to define a family of isogenies $\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \to \mathcal{A}_3$, where $\mathcal{A}_3$ is a principally polarized unitary abelian variety of signature $(2,1)$ over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$. After restricting to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$, the existence of such a family of isogenies will allow us to identify $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ with $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ (through a map obtained by observing that the Hodge filtration of $\mathcal{A}_3$ comes with a natural refinement).

The following lemma will allow us to construct subgroups from quotients of the co-Lie algebra of an abelian variety.

Lemma 4.1. *Given a scheme S of characteristic p, there exists an equivalence of categories*

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} p\text{-torsion finite flat group} \\ \text{schemes } G/S \text{ with } F_G = 0 \end{array} \right\} \longleftrightarrow \left\{ (\mathcal{M}, V : \mathcal{M} \to \mathcal{M}^{(p)}) \,|\, \mathcal{M} \text{ locally free over } S \right\}.$$

The functor is given by sending $G \mapsto (\omega_G, V_G : \omega_G \to \omega_G^{(p)})$.

Proof. This is [Jon93, Example 2.3.]. □

The following observation will also be useful

Lemma 4.2. *Given a scheme $S/\operatorname{Spec}\mathbb{F}_{p^2}$, and a finite flat group scheme G/S of order p. Then if G has an $\mathcal{O}_E$-action it must be an F,V-kernel.*

Proof. We can check this pointwise, so it suffices to assume that $S = \operatorname{Spec} k$. Next, note that $\mathcal{D}(G)_{\operatorname{Spec} k}$ is 1-dimensional over k. Hence it must be isomorphic to an isotypic component under the $\mathcal{O}_E$-action. Since Frobenius and Verschiebung exchanges isotypic components we deduce that they must both be zero. □

Remark 4.3. This lemma shows in particular that Sh_K has empty ordinary locus.

The construction will now proceed in three steps. First, we will construct a sequence of order p isogenies of abelian varieties over $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$

$$\mathcal{A}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}_1 \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}_2.$$

After restricting to the stratum $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21} \subseteq \mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$, we can define a final order p isogeny

$$\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}_3,$$

to a family of unitary abelian varieties $\mathcal{A}_3$ of type $(2,1)$ defined over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$.

The reason for breaking up the isogeny $\mathcal{A}' \to \mathcal{A}_3$ into pieces, is to ensure that the kernel at each step is an F,V-kernel (this will not be true for the composition). This will allow us to apply the lemmas from §2.4. Let us remark that the kernel of the isogeny $\mathcal{A}' \to \mathcal{A}_2$ *will* be an F,V-kernel, so in principle we only need to factor $\mathcal{A}' \to \mathcal{A}_3$ into a composition of two isogenies. However, we still choose to break it up into three pieces, as the effort is minimal, and it illustrates that the isogeny $\mathcal{A}_1 \to \mathcal{A}_3$ gives a $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$-valued point at the Iwahori level Shimura variety of type $(2,1)$.

An important point of this construction is that it should allow us to describe the automorphic vector bundles when pulled back to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \subseteq \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$, in terms of line bundles restricted from $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$. Thus, it will be important to at each step relate the isotypic decomposition of $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_i}$ and $\mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_i^\vee)$ to automorphic line bundles restricted from $\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}$.

4.1.1. *The first isogeny.* Consider the surjection

$$\omega_{\mathcal{A}'} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2.$$

Since $\omega_{\mathcal{A}'} = \ker V_{\mathcal{A}'}$, we can apply Lemma 4.1 to obtain an F,V-kernel $G_0 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{A}'$. Let $\mathcal{A}_1$ denote $\mathcal{A}'/G_0$. Note that it immediately inherits an $\mathcal{O}_E$-action, since G_0 is $\mathcal{O}_E$-stable. Applying Lemma 2.9, we get the following diagram with exact rows, describing the Hodge filtrations

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2)^{(p)} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}_1} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}'} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2 & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_1) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}') & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \simeq} & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2 & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_1^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}'^\vee) & \longrightarrow & (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2)^{(p)} & \longrightarrow & 0.
\end{array}$$

Furthermore, we have that the isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}} \cong (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2)^{(p)}$ is given by the isomorphisms

$$V_{\mathcal{A}'}(\mathcal{D}(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}}) \cong \omega_{G_0}^{(p)} \cong (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2)^{(p)}.$$

Hence, by Lemma 3.9 ii), it is natural to identify the quotient $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}') \to \mathcal{D}(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}}$ with the quotient $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}') \to \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}$. We will also identify $\mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G_0)_{\mathcal{F}l'_{K'}}) \cong \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}$ (using Lemma 2.8). Note that everything in the above diagram is $\mathcal{O}_E$-equivariant, hence we can deduce the following decompositions into isotypic components

$$\omega_{\mathcal{A}_1} \cong \omega_{\mathcal{A}_1,\tau_0} \oplus \omega_{\mathcal{A}_1,\tau_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_2 \oplus \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{2,\perp} \tag{6}$$

and

$$\mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_1^\vee) \cong \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_1^\vee)_{\tau_0} \oplus \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_1^\vee)_{\tau_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_2 \oplus \mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}.$$

In particular, $\mathcal{A}_1$ is of type $(2,1)$.

Remark 4.4. $\mathcal{A}_1$ will turn out to be of special level (i.e. the level at p corresponds to the other, non-hyperspecial, maximal parahoric), and since we have only used $\mathcal{F}_2$ in its construction, this will actually give a disjoint union of irreducible components, each isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}^2$, in the special fiber of the special level Shimura variety of type $(2,1)$.

4.1.2. *The second isogeny.* Next, we consider the quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_1} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{F}_2/\mathcal{F}_1$ (the map is the obvious one from (6)). For the same reason as before, the quotient is $V_{\mathcal{A}_1}$-stable, and we obtain an F,V-kernel $G_1 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{A}_1$. Let $\mathcal{A}_2$ denote $\mathcal{A}_1/G_1$. Copying the argument of the previous section gives us the following diagram with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}_2} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}_1} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_2/\mathcal{F}_1 & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle =} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_1) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
 & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle =} & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_2/\mathcal{F}_1 & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_2^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_1^\vee) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{2,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} & \longrightarrow & 0
\end{array}$$

We can also read off the following decompositions into isotypic components

$$\omega_{\mathcal{A}_2} \cong \omega_{\mathcal{A}_2,\tau_0} \oplus \omega_{\mathcal{A}_2,\tau_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_1 \oplus \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp}. \tag{7}$$

and

$$\mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_2^\vee) \cong \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_2^\vee)_{\tau_0} \oplus \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_2^\vee)_{\tau_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1 \oplus \mathcal{G}^{1,\perp}. \tag{8}$$

In particular, we see that $\mathcal{A}_2$ has type $(1,2)$. Finally, let us note that by combining Lemmas 2.8 and 3.9, we get

$$F_{\mathcal{A}_2} : (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1)^{(p)} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2).$$

and

$$V_{\mathcal{A}_2} : \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp})^{(p)} \subseteq \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2)^{(p)}. \tag{9}$$

4.1.3. *The third isogeny.* Let us now restrict to the closed stratum $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$. This allows us to consider the following quotient

$$\omega_{\mathcal{A}_2}|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp}. \tag{10}$$

Lemma 4.5. *The kernel of* (10) *is $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}$-stable.*

Proof. Since $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}$ exchanges the isotypic components, we see that it suffices to check that $\mathcal{F}_1 = \omega_{\mathcal{A}_2,\tau_0}$ does not meet $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}^{-1}((\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)})$. But we have from (9) that $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1) = (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp})^{(p)}$. In particular, since $(\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}$ is a quotient of the latter, $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}^{-1}((\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)})$ must be given by a subquotient of $\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1$. In particular, it does not meet to $\mathcal{F}_1$. □

We can now apply Lemma 4.1 to obtain an $\mathcal{O}_E$-stable subgroup G_3 of $\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}$ of order p corresponding to (10). Let $\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \to \mathcal{A}_3$, denote the corresponding isogeny. Moreover, Lemma 4.2 implies that G must be an F, V-kernel. Thus we can apply Lemma 2.9 to determine the Hodge filtration as follows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}_3} & \longrightarrow & \omega_{\mathcal{A}_2} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp} \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow \simeq & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow 0 \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G_3)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{D}(G_3)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \downarrow 0 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \simeq \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp} & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^{\vee}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_2^{\vee}) & \longrightarrow & (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)} \longrightarrow 0
\end{array}$$

The following lemma gives a better description of $\mathcal{D}(G_3)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}$ as a subquotient of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$. This will be useful for showing that $\mathcal{A}_3$ is principally polarized.

Lemma 4.6. *Over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$, we have that $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1) = (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}$. In particular we can identify $\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$, viewed as a subquotient of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$ via $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) \to \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) \to \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$, with $\mathcal{D}(G_3)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}$.*

Proof. The second part follows from the first by recalling that the isomorphism $\mathcal{D}(G_3)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \cong (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}$ in the above diagram is induced by $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}$. So it remains to show that $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1) = (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}$ over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$. We will do this by applying Lemma 2.8 to a *different* sequence of isogenies $\mathcal{A}' \to \mathcal{A}'_1 \to \mathcal{A}_2$ (this one will only be defined over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$). Letting G'_0, G'_1 denote the corresponding kernels, the point is that we will pick G'_0 such that $\mathcal{D}(G'_0)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \cong \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp}$. Let us carry out this strategy now. We will be brief since the construction of these isogenies is essentially identical to what has been done above (i.e. apply Lemmas 4.1 and 2.9). All of the following will take place over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$. Let $\mathcal{A}' \to \mathcal{A}'_1$ be obtained from the quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}'} \to \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$, and then note that $\mathcal{A}'_1 \to \mathcal{A}_2$ can be obtained from the quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}'_1} \to \mathcal{G}^1/\mathcal{F}_1$ (indeed, the composition of the isogenies corresponds to the quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}'} \to \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{F}_1$). By Lemma 3.9 iii) we have that $F_{\mathcal{A}}((\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}) = \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$. An application of Lemma 2.8 then shows that

$$V_{\mathcal{A}'_1}(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1) = \mathcal{H}^0(\Delta(G'_1)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})^{(p)} \cong (\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}.$$

Finally, one observes that both $\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$ and $\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^\perp$ lie in the image of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$, and hence the same equality must hold in $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$ using $V_{\mathcal{A}_2}$. □

We can now prove the following theorem.

Theorem 4.7. *The abelian variety $\mathcal{A}_3/\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$ is a principally polarized unitary abelian variety of signature $(2,1)$. Furthermore, $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_0}$ obtains a natural filtration*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1 \longrightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_0} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

and we also get

$$\omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_1^\perp/\mathcal{G}^{1,\perp}.$$

The isotypic components of $\mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^\vee)$ *can similarly be described via*

$$\mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^\vee)_{\tau_0} \cong \mathcal{G}^1/\mathcal{F}_1.$$

and

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^\perp \longrightarrow \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^\vee)_{\tau_1} \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}^{1,\perp} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. The description of isotypic components easily follows from (7), (8) and the description of the Hodge filtration above. This also implies that the signature of $\mathcal{A}_3$ is $(2,1)$. It remains to check that the polarization $p\lambda_0$ on $\mathcal{A}'$ descends to a principal polarization on $\mathcal{A}_3$. Let H denote the kernel of $\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \to \mathcal{A}_3$. Consider the short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Im}(\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3)) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(H)_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}} \longrightarrow 0.$$

If we can show that $\mathrm{Im}(\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3))$ is maximally isotropic with respect to the polarization λ on $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$, we would be done, as then the polarization $p\lambda_0$ on $\mathcal{A}'$ must descend to a principal polarization on $\mathcal{A}_3$. Now, the morphism $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3) \to \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}})$ is nothing but the following composition of morphisms

$$\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_2|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_1|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}}).$$

Hence, tracing through diagrams established above (and applying Lemma 4.6), we see that the image can be identified with $\mathcal{G}^1 \oplus \mathcal{G}^{1,\perp}$. This is clearly maximally isotropic for λ, so we are done. □

Remark 4.8. As alluded to earlier, one can show that the morphism $\mathcal{A}_1 \to \mathcal{A}_3$ gives us a $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$-valued point of the corresponding "Iwahori level" Shimura variety. It is possible to use this to identify $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$ with a disjoint union of irreducible components at Iwahori level.

Proposition 4.9. *The abelian variety $\mathcal{A}_3/\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21}$ induces a morphism $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21} \to \mathcal{F}l_K$.*

Proof. From Theorem 4.7, $\mathcal{A}_3$ is a principally polarized unitary abelian variety of type $(2,1)$. Furthermore, the theorem also gives us a refinement of the Hodge filtration. Thus, to obtain a morphism $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_{21} \to \mathcal{F}l_K$, it remains to equip $\mathcal{A}_3$ with a level structure. Since the isogeny is of p-power degree, we can simply transfer the K'^p-level structure of $\mathcal{A}'$ to a K^p-level structure of $\mathcal{A}_3$ via the isogeny we just constructed. □

4.2. **Identification of the closed strata.** The morphism of Proposition 4.9 will not be injective, but its restriction to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ will be. Therefore, let $\iota : \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \mathcal{F}l_K$ denote the restriction of this morphism to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$. The goal of this subsection is to use ι to identify $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ with $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$.

Lemma 4.10. *The filtration of $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_0}$ given by*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1 \longrightarrow \omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_0} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

satisfies $\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1 = F_{\mathcal{A}_3}((\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1)^{\perp,(p)})$. In particular, ι factors through $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$.

Proof. The fact that ι factors through $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ follows from the first part by using the explict description of the refined conjugate filtration in (4).

For the first part of the Lemma, it follows from Lemmas 4.6 and 2.8 that $F_{\mathcal{A}_3}((\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)}) = \mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1$. Note that $(\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp}) \subseteq \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^{\vee})_{\tau_1}$ by Theorem 4.7. Let $\mathcal{E}$ denote the pre-image of $(\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})$ under the morphism $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3)_{\tau_1} \to \mathrm{Lie}(\mathcal{A}_3^{\vee})_{\tau_1}$. This is an extension of $(\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})$ by $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_3,\tau_1}$. Chasing through the construction, one sees that $\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1 \oplus \mathcal{E}$ is exactly the kernel of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3) \to \mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1})$, and since the image is totally isotropic, we must have that $(\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1)^{\perp} = \mathcal{E}$ in $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}_3)$. Now the Lemma follows from the fact that $F_{\mathcal{A}_3}(\mathcal{E}^{(p)}) = F_{\mathcal{A}_3}((\mathcal{G}^{3,\perp}/\mathcal{F}_1^{\perp})^{(p)})$. □

Proposition 4.11. *The map $\iota : \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ is an isomorphism.*

Proof. It is possible to construct an inverse to ι, by performing the same process as in §4.1, but starting with the universal family $\mathcal{A}/\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$. Since the fact that this is an isomorphism should be no surprise from the results in [Vol10], let us only sketch this process, and leave the details to the reader. First, on the stratum $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{21}$, we can consider the rank 2 quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}_3} \to \omega_{\mathcal{A}_3}/\mathcal{F}_1$. This gives us a degree p^2-isogeny $\mathcal{A} \to \mathcal{A}'_1$. It is clear that $\mathcal{A}'_1$ is still of type $(2,1)$. The kernel of $\mathcal{A} \to \mathcal{A}'_1$ is not an F,V-kernel (not even on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$), but one can still check pointwise, using Dieudonné theory, that the quotient $\omega_{\mathcal{A}'_1} \to \omega_{\mathcal{A}'_1,\tau_1}$ is V-stable over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$. Thus, this quotient defines an isogeny $\mathcal{A}'_1 \to \mathcal{A}'_2$. It is clear that $\mathcal{A}'_2$ will have type $(3,0)$, and one checks that it is furthermore principally polarized (by showing that the image of $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A}'_2)$ in $\mathcal{H}^1_{\mathrm{dR}}(\mathcal{A})$ is $\mathcal{F}_1 \oplus V^{-1}(\mathcal{F}_1^{(p)}) = \mathcal{F}_1 \oplus \mathcal{F}_1^{\perp}$), and that the induced filtration satisfies the defining condition of $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ (this is easiest to do pointwise using Dieudonné modules). This gives us a map $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2 \to \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$.

Next, one notices that by applying the construction of §4.1 to $\mathcal{A}'_2$ and composing the two isogenies, one gets the multiplication by p isogeny. The same works in the other direction. This implies that the map $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2 \to \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ is the inverse of $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$, so we are done. □

4.3. **The automorphic line bundles.** It is now easy to compute the restriction of the automorphic line bundles to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ as $\mathcal{L}'(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$ for some $\lambda \in X^*(T)$. Namely, from Theorem 4.7, we have the following isomorphism

$$\mathcal{L}(a,b,c,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \cong \mathcal{F}_1^{\otimes a} \otimes (\mathcal{F}_3/\mathcal{G}^1)^{\otimes b} \otimes (\mathcal{G}^1/\mathcal{F}_1)^{\otimes c} \otimes \delta^d. \tag{11}$$

By using the equality $\mathcal{G}^1 = \mathcal{F}_2$ on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$, we can easily compute this as

$$\mathcal{L}(a,b,c,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \cong \mathcal{L}'(b,c,a,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}.$$

A problem with this description is that if (a,b,c,d) is dominant, then (b,c,a,d) will not be. Furthermore, as we mentioned previously, it will be easier compute the global sections if we can view $\mathcal{L}(b,c,a,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$ as the restriction of some line bundle on $\mathcal{F}l'_{K',P^*}$. We can ensure that this is true by shifting the weight by the invertible Hasse invariant of weight $(1,0,p,-p)$ on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$. Shifting by a multiple of $-(b-c)$ of this weight gives us

$$\mathcal{L}'(b,c,a,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \cong \mathcal{L}'(c,c,a-p(b-c),(b-c)p+d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$$

Now the latter can be obtained via restriction from $\mathcal{F}l_{K',P^*}$. We have proved the following theorem.

Theorem 4.12. *We have an isomorphism*

$$\mathcal{L}(a,b,c,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \cong \mathcal{L}'_{P^*}(c,c,a-p(b-c),(b-c)p+d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}.$$

In particular, for the irregular weights $(a,b,b-2,d)$ we get

$$\mathcal{L}(a,b,b-2,d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1} \cong \mathcal{L}'_{P^*}(b-2,b-2,a-2p,2p+d)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}.$$

5. The global sections

Let $p : \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$ denote the composition $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 \to \mathcal{F}l'_{K',P^*} \to \mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$. Our goal in this section is to prove the following theorem, which can be seen as describing the global sections of $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$ for a p-restricted irregular weight λ in terms of spaces of algbebraic modular forms (with explicit regular weights). Here, for a character $\lambda \in X^*(T)$, we let $W(\lambda)$ denote the corresponding dual Weyl module of $G_{\mathbb{F}_p}$, and we let $L(\lambda)$ denote the irreducible representation of highest weight λ (which is the socle of $W(\lambda)$).

Theorem 5.1. *Given an irregular weight $\lambda = (a, b, b-2, d) \in X^*(T)$, set $\lambda_1 := (p+b-1, a, b, d+2)$ and $\lambda_2 = (p+b, p+b-1, a+1, d+1)$. Then, if $a - b \leq p-2$, we have the following exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \omega'(W(\lambda_2)) \longrightarrow p_*(\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}) \longrightarrow \omega'(L(\lambda_1)) \longrightarrow 0.$$

For $a - b = p - 1$ we get $p_*(\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}) = \omega'(L(\lambda_1))$.

Let us first explain how this reduces to a proposition about the cohomology of line bundles on a Deligne-Lusztig variety. Recall from Remark 3.11 that we have the 1-dimensional Deligne-Lusztig variety $\overline{X}_1 \subseteq \mathbb{P}^{2,*}$. It fits into the following diagram, where all squares are cartesian.

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1 & \longrightarrow & \overline{\mathcal{C}}'_1 & \longleftarrow & \overline{X}_1 \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{F}l'_{K',P^*} & \longrightarrow & \text{G-ZipFlag}^{\mu',P^*} & \longleftarrow & G/P^* \cong \mathbb{P}^{2,*} \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'} & \longrightarrow & \text{G-Zip}^{\mu'} & \longleftarrow & *
\end{array}$$

In particular, by pulling back from $\text{G-ZipFlag}^{\mu',P^*}$ we get a line bundle $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^{2,*}}(\lambda)$ on $\mathbb{P}^{2,*}$ for each character $\lambda = (a, a, b, d) \in X^*(T)$. We will let $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda)$ denote the restriction $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^{2,*}}(\lambda)|_{\overline{X}_1}$. Furthermore, it follows from Lang's theorem that $\text{G-Zip}^{\mu'} \cong [*/G(\mathbb{F}_p)]$. Hence, the horizontal arrows on the right are all $\underline{G(\mathbb{F}_p)}$-torsors. In particular $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda)$ is $G(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)$-equivariant. We are now ready to state the following.

Proposition 5.2. *In the setup of the previous theorem, set $\lambda' := (b-2, b-2, a-2p, 2p+d)$ (this is the weight corresponding to λ via Theorem 4.12). Then we have the following exact sequence of $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representations*

$$0 \longrightarrow W(\lambda_2) \longrightarrow H^0(\overline{X}_1, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda')) \longrightarrow L(\lambda_1) \longrightarrow 0.$$

For $a - b = p - 1$ we get $H^0(\overline{X}_1, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda)) = L(\lambda_1)$, as $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representations.

Proof that Proposition 5.2 implies Theorem 5.1. Since the automorphic vector bundles can be obtained via pullback from $\text{G-Zip}^{\mu'}$, it follows from flat base change [Stacks, 02KH] that it suffices to compute the corresponding pushforward along the middle column in the above diagram. Furthermore, by descent, it suffices to compute the pushforward on the right-hand column as $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-equivariant vector bundles. Now, Theorem 4.12 implies that the line bundle on $\overline{X}_1$ corresponding to $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$ is $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda')$, and $W(\lambda_2)$ resp. $L(\lambda_1)$ clearly corresponds to $\omega'(W(\lambda_2))$ resp. $\omega'(L(\lambda_1))$ on $\mathrm{Sh}'_{K'}$. So we are done. □

The rest of this section is now devoted to the proof of Proposition 5.2.

Let us now make a temporary change of setting. Namely, it is somewhat unfortunate that the partial flag variety corresponding to $\mathcal{F}l_{K,P^*}$ is $\mathbb{P}^{2,*}$ and not $\mathbb{P}^2$ (this will introduce a bunch of minus signs in our computations, as the twisting sheaf $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^{2,*}}(n)$ has weight $(0, 0, -n)$ as opposed to $(n, 0, 0)$).

Hence, to avoid excessive minus signs, let us instead work on $\mathbb{P}^2$. We will denote the corresponding closed Deligne-Lusztig variety by $\overline{X}_2$ (which corresponds to $s_2 \in W(T)$). This is the same as the Deligne-Lusztig variety considered in [Vol10], and it follows from [Vol10, Remark 4.11b)] that $\overline{X}_2$ can be identified with the Fermat curve cut out by the equation $x^{p+1} + y^{p+1} + z^{p+1}$. The next two subsections will be devoted to computing global sections of line bundles on $\overline{X}_2$. We will then transfer the results back to $\overline{X}_1$, via the isomorphism $G/P \cong G/P^*$ which sends $g \mapsto w_0 g^{-t} w_0$. This has the effect $(a, b, c, d) \mapsto (-c, -b, -a, -d)$ on weights.

As above, we will use the notation $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(\lambda)$ and $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(\lambda)$ for the line bundle corresponding to the character $\lambda = (a, b, b, d) \in X^*(T)$. Note that $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k, 0, 0, 0) \cong \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k)$ (the usual twisting sheaf). In the next two subsections, we will for simplicity only work with $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k)$, as the general case will follow from twisting by the determinant and multiplier characters. We will also use the notation $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k) := \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k, 0, 0, 0)$.

5.1. **Global sections over $\mathbb{P}^2$.** Let us first recall some results of [Dot89], describing the structure of $H^0(\mathbb{P}^n, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^n}(k))$ as an algebraic GL_n-representation over $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$. Here, $\mathbb{P}^n$ denotes the projective space parametrizing 1-dimensional quotients, and $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^n}(k)$ is the usual twisting sheaf. We will immediately specialize these results to the case $n = 2$ and $k = ap + b$, for $0 \leq a, b < p$.

In this subsection we will be working over $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$.

5.1.1. *p-carry patterns.*

Definition 5.3. Fix $k = ap + b$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$. Given a monomial $x^{\lambda_0} y^{\lambda_1} z^{\lambda_2} \in H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k))$, let $\lambda_{i,0}$ denote the p^0-digit in the p-digit expansion of λ_i (for $i \in \{0, 1, 2\}$). We say that the monomial has "p-carry pattern" $c(\underline{\lambda}) \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ (or just denoted c when no confusion can occur), if $\lambda_{0,0} + \lambda_{1,0} + \lambda_{2,0} = cp + r$ for some remainder $0 \leq r < p$. Let $C(k) \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ denote the set of carry patterns that can arise from a degree k monomial. It inherits a natural ordering coming from the integers.

Note that since we are working with monomials of 3 variables, we have $C(k) \subseteq \{0, 1, 2\}$ for all k as in the definition.

Remark 5.4. In [Dot89], the above is defined for any n and any $k \geq 0$. Instead of an integer c, one obtains a tuple measuring the carrying in each p^i-digit in the p-digit expansion of k. We have specialized it above in order to simplify the notation in what follows.

5.1.2. *Global sections.* The following theorem is a specialization of [Dot89, Theorem]

Theorem 5.5. *Fix $k = ap + b$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$. We have an ordered bijection*

$$\{\textit{sub-representations of } H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k))\} \longleftrightarrow C(k).$$

It is explicitly given by sending $c \in C(k)$ to the subrepresentation of monomials of carry-pattern $\leq c$. In particular, the lattice of subrepresentations is totally ordered, and hence $H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k))$ comes with a natural increasing filtration, which we will call the carry-filtration.

By an easy calculation one deduces the following lemma, which describes the length of the carry-filtration of $H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k))$.

Lemma 5.6. *Fix $k = ap + b$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$. Then we have*

$$C(k) = \begin{cases} \{0\} & \text{if } a = 0 \\ \{0, 1\} & \text{if } a = 1 \text{ or } (2 \leq a \text{ and } p - 3 < b) \\ \{0, 1, 2\} & \text{if } 2 \leq a \text{ and } b \leq p - 3 \end{cases}$$

Let us now describe the irreducible constituents of the carry-filtration explicitly. Note that, we can identify $H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(a))$ with the dual Weyl module $W(a, 0, 0, 0)$.

Corollary 5.7. *Fix $k = ap+b$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$. Then the carry-filtration of the $G_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}$-representation $W(ap+b, 0, 0, 0)$ has the following, ordered, list of irreducible constituents.*

$$\begin{cases} \{L(ap+b,0,0,0)\} & \text{if } a = 0 \\ \{L(ap+b,0,0,0), L((a-1)p+p-1, b+1, 0, 0)\} & \text{if } a = 1 \text{ or } (2 \leq a \text{ and } p-3 < b) \\ \{L(ap+b,0,0,0), L((a-1)p+p-1, b+1, 0, 0), & \\ L((a-2)p+p-1, p-1, b+2, 0)\} & \text{if } 2 \leq a \text{ and } b \leq p-3 \end{cases}$$

The different cases (and the number of irreducible constituents) correspond to the number of possible carry patterns.

Proof. By working explicitly with monomials, it is easy to read off the highest-weight vector in each subrepresentation arising in Theorem 5.5 (pick the highest possible power of x arising in a monomial, then the highest possible power of y for this given power of x). □

Below, we will refer to the irreducible constituent arising as a quotient of the sub-representation containing all monomials of p-carry pattern $c \in C(k)$ as the c-carry factor.

5.2. **Global sections over the Fermat curve.** We will now decompose the global sections of $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k)$ into irreducibles as a $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representation. Recall that for p-restricted weights λ, the $G_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}$-representation $L(\lambda)$ remains irreducible as a $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representation.

To properly account for δ-twists, we need to treat $x^{p+1}+y^{p+1}+z^{p+1}$ as an element of $H^0(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(p+1) \otimes \delta^{-p})$[2]. If we let $j : \overline{X}_2 \to \mathbb{P}^2$ denote the inclusion, we obtain the following short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(ap+b-p-1) \otimes \delta^p \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(ap+b) \longrightarrow j_*\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(ap+b) \longrightarrow 0. \tag{12}$$

Since $H^1(\mathbb{P}^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(k)) = 0$ for any $k \in \mathbb{Z}$, we get the following short exact sequence by taking global sections

$$0 \longrightarrow W((a-1)p+(b-1), 0, 0, p) \longrightarrow W(ap+b, 0, 0, 0) \longrightarrow H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(ap+b)) \longrightarrow 0. \tag{13}$$

The following Lemma is now immediate.

Lemma 5.8. *For $k \leq p-1$, we have $H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k)) = L(k,0,0,0)$ as a $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representation.*

Lemma 5.9. *For $k = ap+b \geq p$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$ and $a+b \leq p-1$. Then the carry-filtration on $W(ap+b,0,0,0)$ restricts to the carry filtration on $W((a-1)p+(b-1),0,0,p)$. In particular, for $a+b \leq p-1$, $H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(ap+b))$ obtains an induced filtration which we will also call the carry-filtration.*

Proof. The assumptions imply that $a \geq 1$, and so $b \leq p-2$. Since the inclusion is given by multiplication by the monomial $x^{p+1}+y^{p+1}+z^{p+1}$, we see that the sum of the p^0 digit of a monomial can increase by at most one, but since $b \leq p-2$, this means that no extra p-carrying can occur. □

Now we are ready to state the main result of this section.

Theorem 5.10. *For $k = ap+b \geq p$, with $0 \leq a, b < p$. We have the following decompositions in the Grothendieck group of $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representations.*

$$H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k)) = \begin{cases} W(b,0,-a,a) + L(p-1, b+1, -(a-1), a-1) + & \\ \qquad L(p-1, p-(a-1), b+2, a-2) & \text{if } a+b \leq p-1, \\ W(b,0,-a,a) + W(p-1,b+1,-(a-1),a-1) + & \\ L(b, p-a, 1, a-1) - L(p-1, b+1, p-(a-2), a-2) & \text{if } a+b \geq p. \end{cases}$$

[2]This can for example be seen by computing the weight of the corresponding partial Hasse invariant, similar to what was done for $\mathcal{F}l_K$ in §3.7.5.

In particular, if $a = 1$ and $b \leq p-2$, we obtain

$$H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(p+b)) = W(b,0,-1,1) + L(p-1, b+1, 0, 0).$$

Furthermore, in the case $a+b \leq p-1$, the three terms correspond (in the order written) to the subquotients of the carry-filtration on $H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(k))$.

Remark 5.11. Let us remark that only the $a = 1, b \leq p-2$ case of this theorem will be used to produce congruences from irregular weights. We include this more general result, as this was useful in earlier stages of the project, and we believe that it could be of independent interest.

Proof of theorem. From (13), we get the following equality in the Grothendieck group of $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representations (using that $\delta^p = \delta$ as a character of $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$).

$$H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(ap+b)) = W(ap+b,0,0,0) - W((a-1)p+(b-1),0,0,1). \tag{14}$$

Corollary 5.7 implies that this difference decomposes further, giving up to three positive, and up to three negative terms. To make calculation easier, we will consider the differences between corresponding terms of the same carry-pattern appearing in (14) separately. Note that for $a+b \geq p$, these individual differences will a priori only make sense in the Grothendieck group, and it is only their total sum that gives an honest representation. Furthermore, it is entirely possible that the positive and negative term of (14) above might not admit factors of the same carry pattern simultaneously, so we will need to take this into account during the calculations below.

Let us start with the terms of (14) corresponding to 0-carrying, these terms will always exist for $k \geq p$ (but note that for $b = 0$ the negative term vanishes). Hence we are lead to consider the difference

$$L(ap+b,0,0,0) - L((a-1)p+(b-1),0,0,1).$$

Using Steinberg's tensor product theorem, we can write this as

$$L(b,0,0,0) \otimes L(0,0,-a,a) - L(b-1,0,0) \otimes L(0,0,-(a-1),a). \tag{15}$$

Let us first decompose the positive term. Since $a < p$, we have that $L(0,0,-aa) \cong W(0,0,-a,a)$ and hence we can apply Klimyk's formula for decomposing the tensor product [Jan03, II 5.8b]. To apply it, we need to know the weight multiplicities of $L(b,0,0,0)$. Since $b < p$, we can describe this representation as the space of degree b homogeneous polynomials. In particular, we can read off the weight multiplicities from the monomials in this space. For a given weight $\lambda \in X(T)$, we let $\chi(\lambda)$ denote the character of $W(\lambda)$, and let $e(\lambda)$ denote the character of the 1-dimensional representation λ. Thus, applying Klimyk's formula gives us (where the indices of the sums appearing are always non-negative)

$$\begin{aligned} W(0,0,-a,a) \otimes L(b,0,0,0) &= \chi(0,0,-a,a) \sum_{x+y+z=b} e(x,y,z,0) \\ &= \sum_{x+y+z=b} \chi(x,y,z-a,a) \\ &= \sum_{x+y\leq b} \chi(x,y,b-x-y-a,a). \end{aligned}$$

Applying the same procedure to the negative term, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} W(0,0,-(a-1),a) \otimes L(b-1,0,0,0) &= \sum_{x+y\leq b-1} \chi(x,y,b-1-x-y-(a-1),a) \\ &= \sum_{x+y\leq b-1} \chi(x,y,b-x-y-a,a). \end{aligned}$$

The difference between these two sums is then

$$\sum_{x+y=b} \chi(x, y, b-x-y-a, a).$$

To simplify this sum further, note that for any character μ and any root α we have $\chi(s_\alpha \cdot \mu) = -\chi(\mu)$ (where the action here is the dot action). Note that $s_{\alpha_1} \cdot (x, y, b-x-y-a, a) = (y-1, x+1, b-x-y-a, a)$. This implies that, if x is not maximal (i.e. $x \neq b$), then there exists a unique triple $(y'-1, x'+1, z', a)$ in the sum that cancels this term. Hence, after cancellations, only the term with $x = b$ remains and we see that the difference in (15) becomes

$$L(0, 0, -a, a) \otimes L(b, 0, 0, 0) - L(0, 0, -(a-1), a) \otimes L(b-1, 0, 0, 0) = W(b, 0, -a, a).$$

In particular this is always an honest representation, and has either one or two irreducible constituents, depending on whether $(b, 0, -a, a)$ lies in the lower or upper alcove (i.e. depending on if $0 \leq a + b \leq p-2$) or not. This gives us the first term in both cases of the theorem.

Let us now apply the same procedure to the terms of (14) corresponding to 1-carrying. In this case, note that $W((a-1)p + (b-1), 0, 0, 0)$ does not admit 1-carrying if $a = 1$. Thus, for $a \geq 2$, we are interested in studying the difference

$$L((a-1)p + p - 1, b+1, 0, 0) - L((a-2)p + p - 1, b, 0, 1).$$

Applying Steinberg's tensor product theorem gives

$$L(p-1, b+1, 0, 0) \otimes L(0, 0, -(a-1), a-1) - L(p-1, b, 0) \otimes L(0, 0, -(a-2), a-1). \tag{16}$$

However, note that we can use this expression to treat the $a \geq 2$ and $a = 1$ cases simultaneously, as the negative term vanishes for $a = 1$. Thus we can proceed without case-splits.

We start by considering the first term of (16). We have that $L(p-1, b+1, 0, 0)$ corresponds to the quotient of $W(p+b, 0, 0, 0)$ spanned by the monomials such that the sum of their exponents in base p has 1-carrying. Hence, its weight spaces all have multiplicity 1, and are given by the non-negative triples $(x, y, z, 0)$ such that $x + y + z = p + b$ and $x, y, z \leq p-1$. This gives us the following equality in the Grothendieck group

$$\begin{aligned} L(p-1, b+1, 0, 0) \otimes L(0, 0, -(a-1), a-1) &= \sum_{\substack{x,y,z \leq p-1 \\ x+y+z=p+b}} \chi(x, y, z-(a-1), a-1) \\ &= \sum_{\substack{x,y \leq p-1 \\ b+1 \leq x+y \leq p+b}} \chi(x, y, p+b-x-y-(a-1), a-1). \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, we obtain

$$L(p-1, b, 0, 0) \otimes L(0, 0, -(a-2), a-1) = \sum_{\substack{x,y \leq p-1 \\ b \leq x+y \leq p+b-1}} \chi(x, y, p+b-x-y-(a-1), a-1).$$

Hence the difference is given by

$$\sum_{\substack{x,y \leq p-1 \\ x+y=p+b}} \chi(x, y, -(a-1), a-1) - \sum_{\substack{x,y \leq p-1 \\ x+y=b}} \chi(x, y, p-(a-1), a-1).$$

As before, we get cancellation of all the terms in the two sums, except when x takes on the maximal value $p-1$ (resp. b). Thus the expression simplifies to

$$\chi(p-1, b+1, -(a-1), a-1) - \chi(b, 0, p-(a-1), a-1).$$

Applying the dot action with respect to α_2 to the negative term gives us

$$\chi(p-1, b+1, -(a-1), a-1) + \chi(b, p-a, 1, a-1).$$

If $a+b>p$ then the latter term lies in the lowest alcove, but the first term is not p-restricted and we do not know its decomposition factors as a $G(\mathbb{F}_p)$-representation. This gives us the second and third terms in the case $a+b\geq p$ of the theorem. Otherwise, if $a+b\leq p-1$ then we can apply the dot action of the simple reflection s_{α_1} and obtain

$$\chi(p-1,b+1,-(a-1),a-1)-\chi(p-a-1,b+1,1,a-1).$$

Notice that the character of the positive term is obtained by reflecting the character of the negative term from the lower to the upper alcove. Hence, in this case, we get that the difference is equal to $L(p-1,b+1,-(a-1),a-1)$ in the Grothendieck group. This gives us the second term of the theorem in the case $a+b\leq p-1$.

If $a=1$, we have now proved the theorem, as there is no 2-carrying. So let us proceed by assuming $a\geq 2$, and consider the terms of (14) corresponding to 2-carrying. In other words, we wish to study (ignoring edge cases for now)

$$L((a-2)p+p-1,p-1,b+2,0)-L((a-3)p+p-1,p-1,b+1,1).$$

Applying Steinberg's tensor product theorem gives

$$L(p-1,p-1,b+2,0)\otimes L(0,0,-(a-2),a-2)-L(p-1,p-1,b+1,0)\otimes L(0,0,-(a-3),a-2).$$

As before, notice that the edge cases $a=2$ and $b=p-2$ can be treated by the same formula, as the corresponding terms vanish in these cases. Hence we can proceed without case splits.

Let us start by studying the first term. Recall that $L(p-1,p-1,b+2,0)$ corresponds to the quotient of $W(2p+b,0,0,0)$ spanned by the monomials such that the sum of their exponents in base p has 2-carrying. Hence its weight spaces all have multiplicity 1, and the characters are given by the triples $(x,y,z,0)$ such that $x+y+z=2p+b$ and $x,y,z\leq p-1$. As before, we get

$$\begin{aligned}L(p-1,p-1,b+2,0)\otimes L(0,0,-(a-2),a-2)&=\sum_{\substack{x,y,z\leq p-1\\ x+y+z=2p+b}}\chi(x,y,z-(a-2),a-2)\\&=\sum_{\substack{x,y\leq p-1\\ p+b+1\leq x+y}}\chi(x,y,2p+b-x-y-(a-2),a-2).\end{aligned}$$

Similarly, we get for the negative term

$$L(p-1,p-1,b+1,0)\otimes L(0,0,-(a-3),a-2)=\sum_{\substack{x,y\leq p-1\\ p+b\leq x+y}}\chi(x,y,2p+b-x-y-(a-2),a-2).$$

Thus, the difference is given by

$$-\sum_{\substack{x,y\leq p-1\\ x+y=p+b}}\chi(x,y,p-(a-2),a-2).$$

As before, we get cancellation of all terms where a is not maximal, i.e. $a\neq p-1$. So the only term that remains is $-\chi(p-1,b+1,p-(a-2),a-2)$. The character here is dominant whenever $a+b\geq p$, giving us only a virtual representation. This concludes the $a+b\geq p$ case of the theorem. Otherwise, if $a+b<p$, applying the dot action of s_{α_2} gives us

$$-\chi(p-1,b+1,p-(a-2),a-2)=\chi(p-1,p-(a-1),b+2,a-2).$$

This proves the the remaining cases of the decomposition.

Finally, let us remark that in the case $a-b\leq p-1$, since the carry filtration restricts to $H^0(\overline{X}_2,\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(ap+b))$ (by Lemma 5.9), the above case splits just correspond to computing each subquotient of this filtration separately (and in order). This finishes the proof of the theorem. □

5.3. **Global sections over $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1'$.** Now we apply the results of the previous section to prove Proposition 5.2.

Proof of Proposition 5.2. Our goal is to compute the global sections of $\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_1}(\lambda')$. Via the isomorphism $G/P \cong G/P^*$ (sending $g \mapsto w_0 g^{-t} w_0$), this corresponds to the following line bundle, where we have also factored out determinant and multiplier twists

$$\mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(2p-(a-b+2)) \otimes \det^{\otimes -(b-2)} \otimes \delta^{-(2p+d)}. \tag{17}$$

Ignoring the twists, we can apply Theorem 5.10 when $a-b \leq p-2$ to get the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow W(p-(a-b+2), 0, -1, 1) \longrightarrow H^0(\overline{X}_2, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_2}(2p-(a-b+2))) \longrightarrow L(p-1, p-1-(a-b), 0, 0) \longrightarrow 0.$$

The proposition now follows in the $a-b \leq p-2$ case by incorporating the determinant and multiplier twists from (17), switching back from $\overline{X}_2$ to $\overline{X}_1$ (which has the effect $(a,b,c,d) \mapsto (-c,-b,-a,-d)$ on weights), and finally shifting by the trivial weight $(p+1, p+1, p+1, 0)$ (corresponding to the character $\det^{p+1}$). The $a-b=p-1$ case follows similarly from Lemma 5.8. □

6. The exotic congruence

6.1. **The Hecke algebra.** Let Q denote the set containing all primes ℓ such that either G (or equivalently G') ramifies at ℓ, or such that K is not hyperspecial at ℓ. Consider the following global Hecke algebra, defined as a restricted tensor product

$$\mathbf{T} := \bigotimes_{\ell \notin Q \cup \{p\}}' \mathbb{Z}_\ell \left[G(\mathbb{Z}_\ell) \backslash G(\mathbb{Q}_\ell) / G(\mathbb{Z}_\ell) \right].$$

A *mod p Hecke eigensystem* is defined to be a morphism $\mathbf{T} \to \overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$. Given an $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$-vector space M equipped with an $\mathbf{T}$-action, any simultaneous eigenvector for the $\mathbf{T}$-action on M gives rise to a mod p Hecke eigensystem. We will say that the mod p Hecke eigensystem *appears in* M.

6.1.1. *Action on coherent cohomology.* The global Hecke algebra $\mathbf{T}$ acts on coherent cohomology groups $H^0(\mathrm{Sh}_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega(\lambda)) = H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ via Hecke correspondences (and similarly in the type $(3,0)$-case). See [Gol14, §6.1] for details.

6.1.2. *Restriction to strata.* The correspondences giving rise to the action of $\mathbf{T}$ involve parametrizing certain prime-to-p isogenies. In particular, since lying on a certain stratum is a condition on the p-torsion, the strata will be invariant under these correspondences. In particular, given any coherent weight λ and any stratum $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_w \subseteq \mathcal{F}l_K$, the space $H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{w,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ is a $\mathbf{T}$-module, and the corresponding restriction maps are Hecke-equivariant.

6.2. **Injectivity of restriction.** Let us now show injectivity on global sections of the restriction map to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ for irregular weights.

Proposition 6.1. *For $p > 3$, the map $H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda)) \to H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{2,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ is injective for all irregular weights $\lambda = (a,b,b-2,d)$ with $0 \leq a-b \leq p-1$. For $p=3$, injectivity holds for $a-b=p-1=2$.*

Proof. For simplicity, let us ignore the multiplier factor and work with the irregular weight $\lambda = (k,0,-2)$ with $0 \leq k \leq p-1$ (since twisting does not affect injectivity). First, let us show that the restriction map to $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}$ is injective. By Lemma 3.7, the partial Hasse invariant ha_{12} vanishes simply on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}$. Hence we have the following exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}(\lambda - \mathrm{ha}_{12}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}(\lambda) \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}} \longrightarrow 0.$$

We need to show that $H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda - \mathrm{ha}_{12}))$ is zero. Note that $\lambda - \mathrm{ha}_2 = (k-p, 0, -3)$. This implies that along any fiber of $\mathcal{F}l_K \to \mathrm{Sh}_K$ (any of which is isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}^1$), we have that $\mathcal{L}(\lambda - \mathrm{ha}_2)|_{\mathbb{P}^1} \cong \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(k-p)$. But $k-p<0$, so the global sections must vanish.

It remains to show that $H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda)) \to H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{2,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ is injective. Assume that $f \in H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ vanishes along $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{2,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}$. Recall from Lemma 3.8 that $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ is a disjoint union of $\mathbb{P}^1$s. The proof of [dG17, Proposition 2.10], shows that $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$ meets each $\mathbb{P}^1$-fiber of $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$ at $p+1$ distinct points. We know that $\mathcal{L}(\lambda)|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1}$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(k)$ along each fiber. Hence, since f vanishes on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$, it must vanish at $p+1$ points of each $\mathbb{P}^1$. Since $k < p+1$, this implies that f must also vanish on $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$. Thus, by Lemma 3.7, f is divisible by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1 \in H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{2,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(p+1,p,1))$ (we ignore the multiplier component, since it does not matter for this argument). Thus, after dividing by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1$, it suffices to show that any section in $H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda - (p+1,p,1))$ must vanish. Note that $\lambda - (p+1,p,1) = (k-p-1,-p,-3)$. One easily observes that the degree along the $\mathbb{P}^1$-fibers is now $k-1$. Thus, dividing by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1$ decreases the degree along the $\mathbb{P}^1$-fibers. Next, it follows from Theorem 4.12 that that (up to twisting) we have $\mathcal{L}((k-p-1,-p,-3))|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2} \cong \mathcal{L}'_{P^*}(0,0,-((3-p)p-(k+3-p-1)))|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1}$. Recall that $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ is just a disjoint union of Fermat curves, and one sees that the degree of the corresponding line bundle is $(p+1)(-p^2+4p-(k+2))$. For $p > 3$ (or $k = p-1$ for $p = 3$), this has negative degree. In particular, division by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1$ also decreases the degree along $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$. Since the degree is now negative, any section of $\mathcal{L}((k-p-1,-p,-3))|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}}$, must vanish along $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2$. By the same argument as before, this implies vanishing along $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_1$. So any section of $\mathcal{L}((k-p-1,-p,-3))|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}}$ is divisible by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1$. Since division by $\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1$ decreases the degree along both 1-dimensional strata, we can repeat this argument indefinitely. This implies that any section of $\mathcal{L}((k-p-1,-p,-3))|_{\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{12}}$ must vanish to infinite degree along $V(\mathrm{ha}_2 \cdot \mathrm{ha}_1)$, so it must be zero. Thus we are done. □

In particular, we obtain the following immediate corollary.

Corollary 6.2. *Fix $\lambda = (a,b,c,d)$ with $0 \le a-b \le p-1$, if $p = 3$ we further assume that $a-b = p-1$. Then every mod p Hecke eigensystem appearing in $H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$ also appears in $H^0(\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_{2,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$.*

6.3. **The congruence.** Let us now show the main theorem of this paper.

Theorem 6.3. *Fix $\lambda = (a,b,c,d)$ with $0 \le a-b \le p-1$. Set $\lambda_1 = (p+b-1,a,b,d+2)$ and $\lambda_2 = (p+b,p+b-1,a+1,d+1)$. If $a-b \le p-2$ and $p > 3$, then every mod p Hecke eigensystem appearing in $H^0(\mathcal{F}l_{K,\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \mathcal{L}(\lambda))$, must appear in either $H^0(\mathcal{F}l'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(L(\lambda_1)))$ or $H^0(\mathcal{F}l'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(W(\lambda_2)))$. If $a-b = p-1$, then the corresponding mod p Hecke eigensystem must appear in $H^0(\mathcal{F}l'_{K',\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p}, \omega'(L(\lambda_1)))$.*

Proof. This follows from Corollary 6.2 and Theorem 5.1, provided we know that the identification $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2 \cong \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ respects the corresponding Hecke operators on both sides. But this is clear, since the identification $\overline{\mathcal{Z}}_2 \cong \overline{\mathcal{Z}}'_1$ is given by a p-power isogeny on the corresponding universal abelian varieties, so in particular it does not affect the action of $\mathbf{T}$ which only involves isogenies of degree coprime to p. □

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